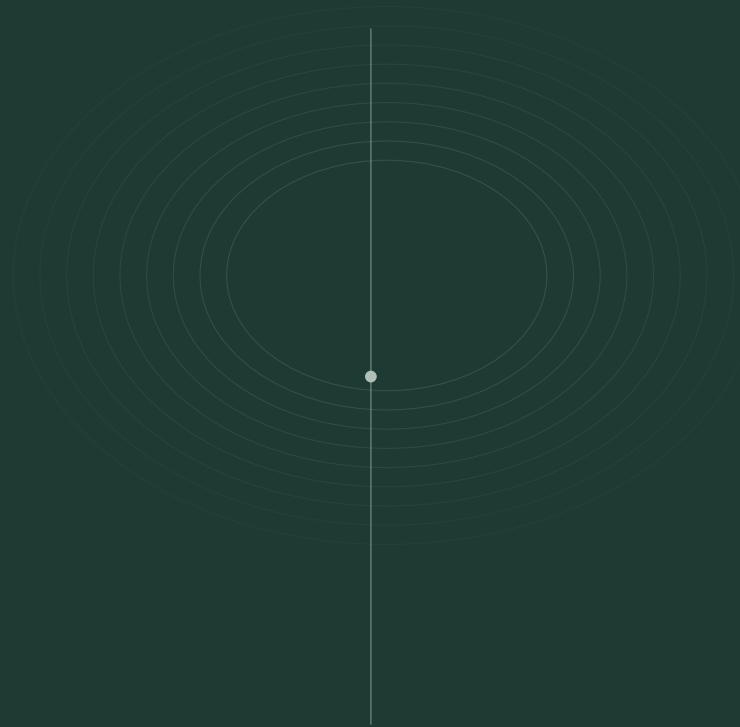


COACH KRIS

ALIGNMENT



Coach Kris

ALIGNMENT • THE ALIGNMENT JOURNEY

THE ALIGNMENT JOURNEY

Build the life that supports the person you are becoming.

See yourself accurately. Build better conditions. Choose your Direction. Face the edge. Learn to return. Become the Compass.

WELCOME TO ALIGNMENT

This is not a seven-day challenge.

Some stages may take a day. Some may take several days. Stage 1 deliberately asks for seven reasonably normal days of observation. Stage 2 may take longer because you are changing physical conditions and living with them long enough to learn from the difference.

The goal is not to finish quickly. The goal is to leave each stage with something you can point to and say:

I learned this about myself.

Alignment is not asking you to copy my routine. My stories, habits and experiments are examples of how I learned about myself. Your job is to collect evidence about how YOU operate.

Do not perform for this Journey.

You do not need a perfect week. You do not need a wearable. You do not need to become healthier before you begin. Start with the life that is actually happening.

THE JOURNEY

Seven stages. One personal operating map.

Don't move on because you finished the pages. Move on when the stage has created evidence.

HOW TO USE ALIGNMENT

YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Before you begin, choose one notebook to use throughout the entire Journey. You do not need to print this guide, annotate a PDF, or squeeze your thinking into small answer boxes.

Whenever you see IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK, write the exercise heading in your notebook and work there. Sometimes one line will be enough. Sometimes you may need several pages. Keep the same notebook with you through all seven stages.

Alignment is the guide. Your notebook becomes your personal operating record.

Evidence, not performance.

- Write what is true, not what sounds impressive.
- Use numbers when they create useful comparison. Stop when they become noise.
- Change one or a few meaningful variables rather than performing a total life overhaul.
- When a prediction appears, record it. Then compare it with what actually happened.
- When life interrupts you, use the Recovery stage rather than turning interruption into failure.
- Revisit the Compass when you need clarity. Put it down when clarity has returned.
- If your schedule is irregular, translate clock-based examples into your own day. "Morning" usually means the first part of your waking period, not a specific hour on the clock.

Measure until you understand. Don't measure forever because you're afraid not to.

HEALTH + SAFETY

Use Alignment as coaching and education - not medical care.

- Genuine hunger, pain, injury, illness, unusual exhaustion, medication needs, safety concerns and new medical information are evidence.
- Wearables are estimates, not diagnoses.
- You do not need to buy a device to complete Alignment.
- Seeking discomfort does not mean chasing pain, danger, restriction or reckless extremes.
- If tracking starts creating compulsive checking or anxiety rather than clarity, simplify it.

THE NEGOTIATOR - A QUICK REFRESHER

The Voice You Feed is recommended, not required.

If you completed The Voice You Feed, you already know this language. If you did not, this page gives you enough context to use Alignment.

You can make a clear decision in one state - then later hear another voice begin negotiating for comfort, familiarity or immediate reward. The important part is that the voice does not sound like an enemy. It sounds like you.

The voice doesn't sound like an enemy. It sounds like you.

Alignment does not ask you to fight every thought. It asks you to notice when a thought is trying to reopen a decision and check whether anything has genuinely changed.

Is there new evidence - or just a new argument?

Decide before you negotiate.

STATE BEFORE STORY

Not every difficult thought deserves to become identity.

Sometimes "I'm too tired" is a negotiation. Sometimes you are genuinely exhausted. Sometimes "I need a break" is avoidance. Sometimes recovery is exactly what the evidence says you need.

Before turning a feeling into a verdict about who you are, check the conditions around it: sleep, nourishment, movement, stress, stimulation, recovery, environment and useful objective information.

State before story.

Did I choose it - or did it choose me?

You will see these questions throughout Alignment. This is not The Voice You Feed 2. Here, the negotiator becomes one part of a larger picture: BODY, MIND, DIRECTION, DISCOMFORT, RECOVERY and the conditions in which you operate.

WANT SUPPORT APPLYING THIS TO YOUR OWN LIFE?

Alignment is designed to work independently - but you do not have to do it alone.

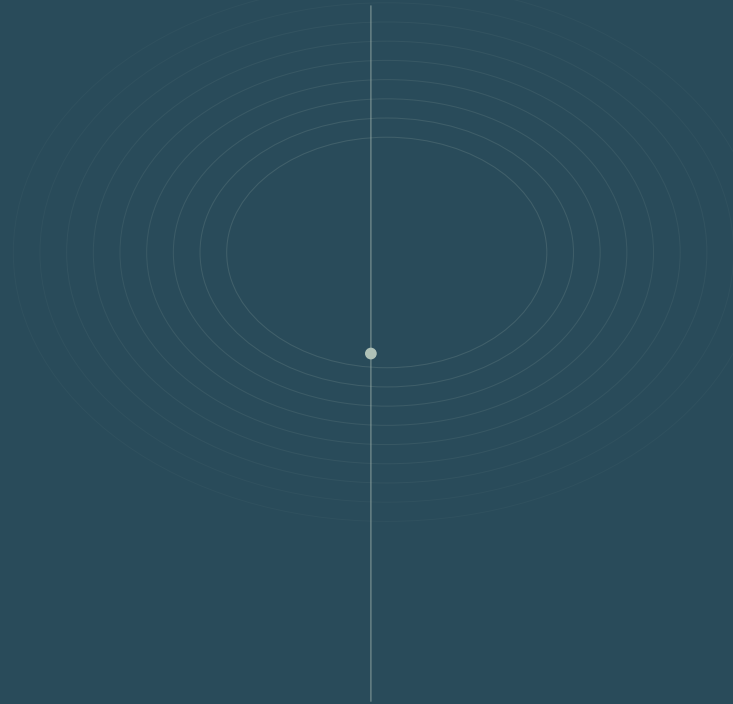
If you want personal support interpreting the evidence, making decisions and applying the work to your real life, you can work with me 1:1.

Explore 1:1 coaching at coachkris.co.uk

STAGE 1

MEET YOURSELF

Have You Ever Actually Met Yourself?



Build the life that supports the person you are becoming.

Coach Kris

ALIGNMENT • THE ALIGNMENT JOURNEY

BEFORE WE CHANGE ANYTHING

I want to see your life.

Do not perform for this Journey. Do not suddenly become the person you think you should be because you started Alignment. Do not clean up the week so the numbers look better.

Measure before you conclude.

Many people have never spent enough time well-rested, well-nourished, active, recovered and mentally clear to know how differently they can think and behave. That is why we are not beginning with a perfect routine. We are beginning with evidence.

Have you ever actually met yourself under the right conditions?

Not a magical hidden version of you. Not a perfect future self. The version of you that appears when the conditions around you change.

For the next seven reasonably normal days, observation IS the work. You are not wasting a week by refusing to overhaul everything. You are creating the comparison the rest of Alignment depends on.

THE SEVEN-DAY BASELINE

No performance. Real life.

For seven reasonably normal days, observe your life. Your job is not to improve it yet. Your job is to notice it.

- Sleep.
- Nourishment.
- Movement.
- Human data - energy, mood, clarity, cravings, stress, digestion and how capable you feel.
- Negotiation - moments when you intended one thing and your mind began arguing for another.

Use wearable or app data if you already have it, but do not buy equipment simply to complete this stage.

Observation can change behaviour. You may notice that measuring something makes you want to improve it, hide it or perform for the page. Notice that reaction too. Do not deliberately optimise the week; awareness itself is part of the data.

Data should create clarity, not another prison.

Measure until you understand. Don't measure forever because you're afraid not to.

DAY 1 - BASELINE

One day. One page. Enough evidence to notice the pattern.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Date / sleep window / approximate sleep duration:
- After waking - whatever time that is - how rested and clear did I feel? What did my first hour contain?

NOURISHMENT

- What did I broadly eat and drink? Any hunger, cravings, satisfaction, energy or automatic eating worth noting?

MOVEMENT + BODY

- What movement did I do? How did my body feel? Steps only if they are available and useful to me.

STATE + NEGOTIATION

- Energy / clarity / mood in a few words. One moment I noticed myself negotiating:
- What had I intended? What did the voice say? Was there new evidence - or just a new argument?

TODAY'S OBSERVATION

- One thing today's evidence showed me:

OPTIONAL DATA - ONLY IF I ALREADY TRACK IT

- Wearable sleep / screen time / nutrition numbers / other:

Do not start tracking extra numbers just for this exercise. Alignment does not require them.

DAY 2 - BASELINE

One day. One page. Enough evidence to notice the pattern.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Date / sleep window / approximate sleep duration:
- After waking - whatever time that is - how rested and clear did I feel? What did my first hour contain?

NOURISHMENT

- What did I broadly eat and drink? Any hunger, cravings, satisfaction, energy or automatic eating worth noting?

MOVEMENT + BODY

- What movement did I do? How did my body feel? Steps only if they are available and useful to me.

STATE + NEGOTIATION

- Energy / clarity / mood in a few words. One moment I noticed myself negotiating:
- What had I intended? What did the voice say? Was there new evidence - or just a new argument?

TODAY'S OBSERVATION

- One thing today's evidence showed me:

OPTIONAL DATA - ONLY IF I ALREADY TRACK IT

- Wearable sleep / screen time / nutrition numbers / other:

Do not start tracking extra numbers just for this exercise. Alignment does not require them.

DAY 3 - BASELINE

One day. One page. Enough evidence to notice the pattern.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Date / sleep window / approximate sleep duration:
- After waking - whatever time that is - how rested and clear did I feel? What did my first hour contain?

NOURISHMENT

- What did I broadly eat and drink? Any hunger, cravings, satisfaction, energy or automatic eating worth noting?

MOVEMENT + BODY

- What movement did I do? How did my body feel? Steps only if they are available and useful to me.

STATE + NEGOTIATION

- Energy / clarity / mood in a few words. One moment I noticed myself negotiating:
- What had I intended? What did the voice say? Was there new evidence - or just a new argument?

TODAY'S OBSERVATION

- One thing today's evidence showed me:

OPTIONAL DATA - ONLY IF I ALREADY TRACK IT

- Wearable sleep / screen time / nutrition numbers / other:

Do not start tracking extra numbers just for this exercise. Alignment does not require them.

DAY 4 - BASELINE

One day. One page. Enough evidence to notice the pattern.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Date / sleep window / approximate sleep duration:
- After waking - whatever time that is - how rested and clear did I feel? What did my first hour contain?

NOURISHMENT

- What did I broadly eat and drink? Any hunger, cravings, satisfaction, energy or automatic eating worth noting?

MOVEMENT + BODY

- What movement did I do? How did my body feel? Steps only if they are available and useful to me.

STATE + NEGOTIATION

- Energy / clarity / mood in a few words. One moment I noticed myself negotiating:
- What had I intended? What did the voice say? Was there new evidence - or just a new argument?

TODAY'S OBSERVATION

- One thing today's evidence showed me:

OPTIONAL DATA - ONLY IF I ALREADY TRACK IT

- Wearable sleep / screen time / nutrition numbers / other:

Do not start tracking extra numbers just for this exercise. Alignment does not require them.

DAY 5 - BASELINE

One day. One page. Enough evidence to notice the pattern.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Date / sleep window / approximate sleep duration:
- After waking - whatever time that is - how rested and clear did I feel? What did my first hour contain?

NOURISHMENT

- What did I broadly eat and drink? Any hunger, cravings, satisfaction, energy or automatic eating worth noting?

MOVEMENT + BODY

- What movement did I do? How did my body feel? Steps only if they are available and useful to me.

STATE + NEGOTIATION

- Energy / clarity / mood in a few words. One moment I noticed myself negotiating:
- What had I intended? What did the voice say? Was there new evidence - or just a new argument?

TODAY'S OBSERVATION

- One thing today's evidence showed me:

OPTIONAL DATA - ONLY IF I ALREADY TRACK IT

- Wearable sleep / screen time / nutrition numbers / other:

Do not start tracking extra numbers just for this exercise. Alignment does not require them.

DAY 6 - BASELINE

One day. One page. Enough evidence to notice the pattern.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Date / sleep window / approximate sleep duration:
- After waking - whatever time that is - how rested and clear did I feel? What did my first hour contain?

NOURISHMENT

- What did I broadly eat and drink? Any hunger, cravings, satisfaction, energy or automatic eating worth noting?

MOVEMENT + BODY

- What movement did I do? How did my body feel? Steps only if they are available and useful to me.

STATE + NEGOTIATION

- Energy / clarity / mood in a few words. One moment I noticed myself negotiating:
- What had I intended? What did the voice say? Was there new evidence - or just a new argument?

TODAY'S OBSERVATION

- One thing today's evidence showed me:

OPTIONAL DATA - ONLY IF I ALREADY TRACK IT

- Wearable sleep / screen time / nutrition numbers / other:

Do not start tracking extra numbers just for this exercise. Alignment does not require them.

DAY 7 - BASELINE

One day. One page. Enough evidence to notice the pattern.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Date / sleep window / approximate sleep duration:
- After waking - whatever time that is - how rested and clear did I feel? What did my first hour contain?

NOURISHMENT

- What did I broadly eat and drink? Any hunger, cravings, satisfaction, energy or automatic eating worth noting?

MOVEMENT + BODY

- What movement did I do? How did my body feel? Steps only if they are available and useful to me.

STATE + NEGOTIATION

- Energy / clarity / mood in a few words. One moment I noticed myself negotiating:
- What had I intended? What did the voice say? Was there new evidence - or just a new argument?

TODAY'S OBSERVATION

- One thing today's evidence showed me:

OPTIONAL DATA - ONLY IF I ALREADY TRACK IT

- Wearable sleep / screen time / nutrition numbers / other:

Do not start tracking extra numbers just for this exercise. Alignment does not require them.

AFTER SEVEN DAYS

Stop guessing. Look.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- What surprised me?
- What repeated?
- When was my energy highest?
- When was my thinking clearest?
- When were negotiations strongest? When were they weaker?
- What seemed to make follow-through easier?
- What seemed to make it harder?
- What am I currently assuming that the data does not support?

COMPASS PIECE #1 - MY CURRENT BASELINE

This is not a verdict. It is your starting point.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- My sleep currently looks like:
- My nourishment currently looks like:
- My movement currently looks like:
- My energy and clarity currently look like:
- My strongest recurring negotiation is:
- My most vulnerable conditions appear to be:
- One assumption about myself I now want to test rather than keep repeating:
- The biggest thing I learned about myself:

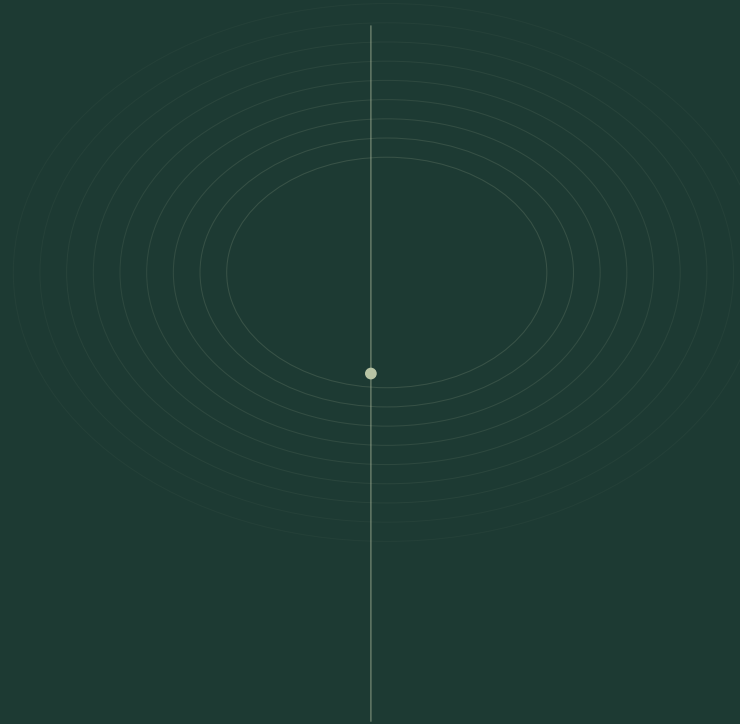
I learned this about myself.

Move on when you have a real baseline - not because the calendar says Day 7. Stage 1 is not asking you to fix yourself. It is asking you to stop building your next plan on guesses.

STAGE 2

THE BODY

Your Body Keeps the Score



Build the life that supports the person you are becoming.

Coach Kris

ALIGNMENT • THE ALIGNMENT JOURNEY

THE BODY IS NOT A SIDE PROJECT

Have you met yourself under different conditions yet?

You have your baseline. Now we begin changing conditions.

SLEEP -> NOURISHMENT -> MOVEMENT -> COMPARE

Sleep gives you capacity. Nourishment gives you materials. Movement gives your body a reason to adapt. Then you compare yourself with the person you met in Stage 1.

Your body is a savings account. Your repeated choices are deposits and withdrawals.

One good night, one supportive meal or one walk does not guarantee a longer life. The point is not certainty. The point is improving the conditions and probabilities while building a body that can participate in your life.

Stage 2 is not a waiting room where you must perfect your health before you are allowed to continue. Stay long enough to create real evidence and a version you are actually repeating. Keep refining it as the Journey continues.

HOW TO RUN THE TESTS

For the cleanest signal, change one major variable at a time. If your real life makes three separate testing weeks unrealistic, you may layer a few simple changes together - just record what changed so you do not pretend you know which variable caused what.

You are looking for useful comparison, not laboratory certainty.

PART 1 - SLEEP

Tomorrow starts tonight.

A tired version of you may have less capacity for attention, movement, patience, learning and protecting decisions you made while clear. That does not mean every difficult thought is "just sleep." It means sleep is an upstream variable worth testing.

- If your schedule allows, test protecting roughly an 8-hour-or-longer opportunity for sleep and observe what happens. This is an Alignment experiment, not a universal requirement.
- Keep bedtime and wake time reasonably consistent where life allows. Look for a repeatable rhythm, not a perfect clock.
- Test a wind-down period long enough to reduce stimulation and unfinished-business friction. Kris often uses about an hour; yours may differ.
- If evening food seems to affect comfort or sleep, test moving larger meals earlier. Do not go to bed deliberately hungry merely to hit a timing rule.
- Keep the room dark, quiet where possible and comfortably cool for you.
- Reduce high-arousal stimulation immediately before bed if it seems to delay settling.

- Consider morning outdoor light as a simple experiment.
- Treat caffeine timing as a test. Move it earlier and compare if sleep seems affected.
- Use wearable sleep stages and scores as estimates, not diagnoses.

SHIFT / IRREGULAR SCHEDULES: If you sleep during the day or rotate shifts, apply the same experiment to your actual sleep block. Focus on opportunity, darkness, quiet, stimulation and repeatability where your rota allows. Alignment does not require a conventional nighttime schedule.

Tomorrow starts tonight.

MY SLEEP TEST

Change something. Live with it. Compare.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- My intended sleep window:
- My wind-down starts:
- One environmental change:
- My caffeine test:
- My evening-food timing test, if relevant:
- Bedtime / wake time / sleep opportunity:
- Estimated sleep if available:
- Rested on waking ___ /10 Morning clarity ___ /10 Energy ___ /10 Evening negotiation strength ___ /10
- What changed compared with Stage 1?
- What did not?
- What do I want to KEEP or ADJUST?

PART 2 - NOURISHMENT

Feed the body you're asking to perform.

My own diet happens to be vegan. Yours does not need to be. Alignment is not asking you to copy my diet; it is asking what supports your body.

Is the food I eat actually giving my body what it needs to operate well?

Not what I think it does. What does the evidence show?

Food is information.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- OPTIONAL - average calories, only if I already track them:
- OPTIONAL - protein / carbohydrate / fat / fibre, only if I already track them:

If I do not currently track these, I leave them blank. I do not need to begin macro tracking to complete Alignment.

- Fruit / vegetable servings or rough variety:
- Final meal time / convenience or ultra-processed pattern / evening snacks:
- Which foods tend to leave me clear, satisfied and well-supported?
- Which tend to leave me heavy, foggy, hungry again quickly or strongly craving more?

FOUR NOURISHMENT QUESTIONS

Keep the Journey practical.

CONSCIOUS COMFORT

Adjust - don't abandon.

Alignment is not a permanent punishment diet. There are foods you may simply want because you enjoy them. That is allowed. But there is a difference between choosing comfort and falling into a comfort loop.

You don't have to turn one enjoyable decision into five.

The point is not to turn every pleasure into a health project. The point is to stop one deliberate choice becoming permission to abandon everything until Monday.

Enjoy it. Adjust what you can. Notice how you feel. Keep one choice from becoming an unconscious pattern. Return with the next decision - not next Monday.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- What did I deliberately choose to enjoy?
- What automatic additions arrived with it?
- Could I have enjoyed the thing with less excess?
- What could I adjust without feeling deprived?
- How did I feel 1-2 hours later?
- How did I sleep? How did I feel the next morning?
- Did the choice end where I intended it to end?

Why are the days you've been waiting all week to enjoy the days you're designing to feel worst in?

Design your comfort so you actually get to experience the comfort.

NOURISHMENT - COMPARE

Keep what helps. Adjust what does not.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Energy: Stage 1 ___ -> Now ___
- Cravings: Stage 1 ___ -> Now ___
- Clarity: Stage 1 ___ -> Now ___
- Hunger / satisfaction: Stage 1 ___ -> Now ___
- Digestion / sleep / food negotiation:
- What do I want to KEEP?
- What do I want to ADJUST?
- What do I want to STOP PRETENDING works for me?

PART 3 - MOVEMENT

Your body was built to participate.

You do not need to love the gym. You do need to challenge the idea that avoiding every form of physical discomfort is automatically taking care of yourself.

Seek discomfort to find comfort.

Walk. Carry. Climb. Squat. Push. Pull. Move in ways appropriate to your body and build the capability you want to keep.

Your physical capability is a savings account. Movement is how you make deposits.

EFFORT IS NOT INJURY

Unfamiliar effort, working muscles, nervousness or appropriate challenge can be discomfort. Sharp pain, worsening joint pain, dizziness, illness, injury symptoms or medical warning signs are evidence to stop or adjust - not discomfort to prove you can tolerate.

If a health condition, injury, pregnancy, medication or uncertainty changes what is appropriate for you, adapt the experiment and use qualified professional guidance where needed.

CAPABILITY, NOT FITNESS

What would feeling physically capable mean in your life - from where you are now?

Alignment does not give everybody the same picture of the "correct" body. The destination is personal capability and participation, not one fitness identity.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- I want to be able to walk:
- I want to be able to carry:
- I want enough strength to:
- I want enough cardiovascular fitness to:
- I want enough mobility to:
- I want enough balance / confidence to:
- As I get older, I want to remain able to:
- Which of these things can I not comfortably do today?

That is a target.

DON'T CHASE 10,000

Challenge your normal.

A universal step target is not the point. The next target should create meaningful change without demanding an unsustainable jump.

- If averaging under roughly 1,000 steps, a first challenge might be consistently getting above that.
- If around 1,000, you might work progressively toward 2,000-3,000.
- If around 3,000, 5,000 may become a useful Alignment landmark if walking is safe and appropriate for you.
- If you already move a lot - through work, caring, manual labour or training - the next useful change may not be more steps. It may be strength, mobility, balance, a different type of movement, or more recovery.

Don't worship the number. Ask what your body needs next.

High movement volume can still leave a person under-recovered or missing a capability. Ask what the movement is doing for you, not only how much of it you did.

Steps measure movement. They do not measure your entire capability.

When your normal improves, your challenge has to move with it.

"I HATE THE GYM"

Maybe you do.

Do not automatically label that sabotage. Ask what you actually hate: the environment, feeling watched, not knowing what to do, a past experience, the discomfort, or simply that you prefer another form of movement.

The goal is movement and capability - not gym identity.

- Walk or use hills/stairs where appropriate.
- Carry groceries or another sensible real-life load.
- Use manageable resistance or a light backpack where safe.
- Practise sit-to-stands, wall or incline pushing, bodyweight movements or other appropriate basics.
- Use professional guidance when health conditions, pain, injury, disability, pregnancy or uncertainty make exercise selection unclear.

Do not turn "seek discomfort" into reckless lifting or unsafe challenges.

THE MOVEMENT TEST

Challenge your normal safely. For some people, the next challenge is doing less.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- My current normal:
- Does my body need more challenge, a different challenge, or more recovery?
- My next challenge:
- What I expect will happen:
- What feels uncomfortable about it:
- Is anything unsafe, painful or medically inappropriate?
- What happened when I did it?
- What was easier than expected? What was harder?
- How did I feel later? How did I recover?

- What can my body now do more easily than before?

The edge of your comfort isn't necessarily the edge of your capability.

Capability needs evidence.

You borrow a little discomfort now to buy more comfort later.

STAGE 2 - COMPARE

Have you met yourself under different conditions yet?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Sleep / restedness: Before ___ -> Now ___
- Energy: Before ___ -> Now ___
- Clarity: Before ___ -> Now ___
- Cravings / hunger stability: Before ___ -> Now ___
- Movement / capability: Before ___ -> Now ___
- Negotiation strength: Before ___ -> Now ___
- Recovery: Before ___ -> Now ___
- What changed most?
- What changed least?
- Which physical condition created the biggest positive ripple?
- What did I previously call "my personality" that may have partly been my state?

COMPASS PIECE #2 - MY BODY

Build the version that can travel with you.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- My body operates better when my sleep looks like:
- My body operates better when my nourishment looks like:
- My body operates better when my movement looks like:
- The capability I am building toward is:
- My strongest physical warning signs are:
- My easiest physical reset is:

- One physical condition I do not want to keep negotiating away:
- The biggest thing I learned about my body:

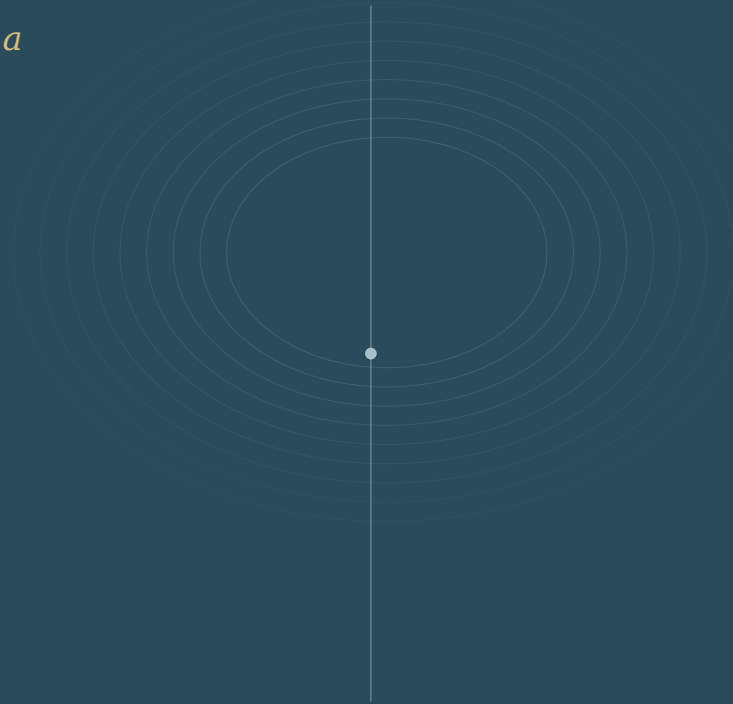
You do not need your Body completely solved before Stage 3. Move on when you have lived with meaningful changes long enough to compare them with Stage 1, the behaviours are becoming more repeatable, and you know what you want to keep testing.

Measure until the unknown becomes knowable. Repeat until the deliberate starts becoming natural.

STAGE 3

THE MIND

Not Every Thought Deserves to Become a Decision



Build the life that supports the person you are becoming.

Coach Kris

STAGE OPENER

You Can Hear the Voice. Now Look at the Mind It Lives In.

You have already started noticing the negotiation in the opening refresher: a clear decision can later be reopened by a familiar, comfort-seeking argument.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- You learned to ask:

Is there new evidence - or just a new argument?

- And:

Did I choose it - or did it choose me?

Now we're going deeper.

You've started changing the conditions around your body through sleep, nourishment and movement.

- This stage asks:

What conditions are you giving your mind to operate inside?

This isn't about controlling every thought.

It isn't about becoming positive all the time.

It is about understanding what affects your mental state, what repeatedly takes your attention, which stories you've mistaken for identity, and what happens when you deliberately create new evidence.

Mental vitality is about clear thinking, adaptability, emotional steadiness, motivation and attention - not simply "thinking positively."

YOUR WIN FROM THIS STAGE

I learned what helps my mind work for me - and what repeatedly pulls it away.

YOUR OUTPUT

COMPASS PIECE #3 - MY MIND

STATE BEFORE STORY

Don't Diagnose Your Life From One Bad State.

"I'm lazy."

"I can't focus."

"I have no discipline."

"I'm useless in the mornings."

"I'm just an anxious person."

Maybe.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- But before turning a feeling into an identity:

Check the conditions.

Use the State Before Story check you met at the beginning of Alignment: sleep, nourishment, movement, stress, stimulation, recovery and useful objective information can all change the quality of the decision you're making.

THE STATE CHECK

- A story I'm telling myself today:
- Sleep:
- Nourishment:
- Movement:
- Stress:
- Stimulation:
- Recovery:
- Connection:
- Available data:

NOW ASK

- Does the evidence support the story?
- What would be a more accurate description of what is happening?

Your current state is information. It is not automatically your identity.

DESIGN YOUR ATTENTION

Your Attention Is Part of Your Environment.

Your environment isn't only your bedroom, kitchen or workplace.

It is also what repeatedly enters your mind.

Messages. Videos. News. Emails. Notifications. Advertising. Social media. Other people's lives. Other people's opinions.

The question isn't whether technology is good or bad.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The question is:

Who decides what gets access to you?

A PERSONAL NOTE FROM KRIS

My phone doesn't sleep beside me.

I charge it in another room.

When I wake, I make water, get dressed and try to get outside as quickly as I can. I'll usually check my phone during my walk, so most mornings I've already been awake for 30 minutes to an hour before properly engaging with it.

I've also turned off almost every individual notification.

And I'm still working on this.

- Sometimes I notice:

Facebook -> email -> Instagram -> Facebook.

At that point I'm not really looking for anything.

I'm just reaching.

That's my signal to put the phone away.

The goal isn't to never use your phone. The goal is to decide when your phone gets access to you.

YOUR ATTENTION BASELINE

Measure Before You Change It.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Average daily screen time:
- Most-used app:
- Phone pickups/unlocks, if available:
- First thing I normally consume after waking:
- Last thing I normally consume before sleeping:
- The app/site I open most automatically:
- When I'm bored, I usually:
- When I'm stressed, I usually:
- When I'm avoiding something, I usually:

SIT WITH THIS

- Which of these behaviours do I deliberately choose?
- Which ones seem to happen before I've really decided?

Did I choose it - or did it choose me?

CHANGE THE CONDITIONS

Don't Ask Willpower to Do Everything.

TEST 1 - ENTER YOUR OWN DAY FIRST

Tomorrow, delay unnecessary phone use.

Not forever.

Not because phones are evil.

Just long enough to discover what happens.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- I will wait until:
- Before that I will:

Afterwards

- Discomfort (0-10):
- What did the voice say?
- How did the morning feel?
- Did I actually miss anything important?

Before you consume the world, enter your own day.

TEST 2 - REMOVE THE SUMMONS

- Which notifications genuinely deserve immediate access to me?
- Which can wait?
- Which can disappear completely?

Make the changes.

Don't only strengthen the person. Change the conditions around the person.

PROTECT AN EXPERIENCE

Be Where You Are.

I try not to use my phone while eating.

Not because somebody told me phones at meals are morally wrong.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- I noticed something simpler:

I enjoy the meal more when I'm actually there for it.

Where is divided attention reducing something you supposedly want to enjoy? Meal? Walk? Partner? Children? Friend? Training? Film? Bedtime? Something else?

THIS EXPERIENCE BELONGS TO ME

- I am going to protect:
- My boundary will be:
- What did I notice that I normally miss?
- Did I enjoy it differently?
- What felt uncomfortable?

NOTICE THE LOOP

When Looking Becomes Reaching.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Your loop might be:

Instagram -> email -> TikTok -> Instagram.

- Or:

Slack -> email -> LinkedIn -> Slack.

The apps don't matter.

- The clue is:

You aren't really looking for anything anymore.

MY LOOP

- Mine looks like:
- I usually enter it when I feel:
- What was I actually trying to find?
- Did I have a purpose? YES / NO

MY INTERRUPTION

- When I notice the loop, I will:
- It can be as simple as:

Put it down.

Break the loop first. Then get curious.

CONSCIOUS COMFORT

Contain It. Don't Pretend You Don't Want It.

I sometimes deliberately allow myself time to scroll in the evening.

I've chosen it.

I've contained it.

I'm participating in the decision.

That's different from opening the same apps repeatedly throughout the day without really deciding.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- This is the same principle you've already used with food:

Comfort should be somewhere you visit, not somewhere you're trapped.

MY DELIBERATE COMFORT

- Something I enjoy:
- When I consciously choose to enjoy it:
- Where I don't want it leaking into my life:
- What boundary would allow me to enjoy it without being controlled by it?

The goal isn't maximum control. It's conscious participation in your own life.

SEEK MENTAL DISCOMFORT

What happens when nothing is feeding your attention?

Try a short period with no incoming stimulation. No scrolling. No podcast. No music. No video.

You are not trying to empty your mind or perform calmness. You are noticing what your mind asks for when nothing is feeding it.

Start smaller if needed. Five useful minutes of observation is better than twenty minutes spent white-knuckling the exercise.

If you are acutely sleep-deprived, ill, or genuinely need recovery, prioritise that first. This is an attention experiment, not a reason to override real exhaustion.

MY UNSTIMULATED TIME

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- I will try (minutes):
- Where:
- What did my mind immediately ask for?
- What did I notice underneath the urge for stimulation?
- If I got caught inside thought, what concrete anchor brought me back - breath, feet, surroundings, movement, sensation?
- Did the discomfort change when I stayed with it?

The goal is not an empty mind. The goal is to stop treating every uncomfortable mental state as an instruction to escape.

CHALLENGE "THAT'S JUST ME"

Be Careful What You Turn Into Identity.

"I hate exercise."

"I can't cook."

"I'm terrible socially."

"I'm not a morning person."

"I could never put my phone somewhere else."

"I can't learn that."

Maybe those things describe your current reality.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- But:

When did today's reality become permanent?

THREE STORIES I REPEAT

- 1. "I'm / I can't"
- 2. "I'm / I can't"
- 3. "I'm / I can't"

Choose one.

THE FACTS

- What evidence actually supports it?
- When did I start believing it?
- Have I seriously tested the opposite recently?
- What evidence would make me update the story?

BE WILLING TO BE A BEGINNER

Your Ego Likes Competence.

I'm a strong swimmer.

But I couldn't properly swim front crawl.

That bothered me.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- I could have protected my ego:

Whatever. I can swim. That's just the stroke I can't do.

Or I could become curious.

Why can't I? What am I doing wrong? What do I need to learn? Can I tolerate being bad at something long enough to get better?

Adults often find this uncomfortable because we're used to already knowing what we're doing.

Today's capability doesn't have to become tomorrow's identity.

THE BEGINNER CHALLENGE

- Something I would like to learn:
- What makes being bad at it uncomfortable?
- What is my smallest real first step?
- When will I do it?

AFTERWARDS

- What did I learn that thinking about it could never have taught me?

Capability needs evidence.

MAP THE EDGE

Discomfort is information. Not always an instruction.

Social discomfort can be extremely ordinary: entering a room alone, asking a question you worry is obvious, trying something you are visibly new at, introducing yourself first, asking for help, or saying no.

The lesson is not to perform strange stunts. The lesson is to notice how much another person's possible opinion can influence a harmless decision.

Danger deserves respect. Pain deserves attention. Discomfort deserves investigation.

MY EDGE

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Something I avoid:

- What do I predict will happen?
- What am I actually afraid of?
- Is there a genuine safety issue - or mainly discomfort / unfamiliarity?
- How can I make the challenge safe but still real?
- My next step:

AFTER I DO IT

- What actually happened? What was easier or harder than expected?
- What did I discover about myself?

The edge of your comfort isn't necessarily the edge of your capability.

CREATE NEW EVIDENCE

Stop Arguing With the Story. Test It.

Choose one belief from this stage.

KEEP THIS SHORT. Three sentences are enough. Writing is not the evidence this exercise is asking for; the test happens in the real world.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- OLD STORY:
- WHAT I PREDICT WILL HAPPEN:
- THE TEST:
- WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED:
- NEW EVIDENCE:
- DOES THE OLD STORY STILL DESERVE TO STAY EXACTLY THE SAME?

Now rewrite it using the evidence.

- OLD - "I..."
- MORE ACCURATE - "Right now..., but I have evidence that..."

That is not positive thinking.

That's updating the model.

MY MIND RULES + COMPASS PIECE #3

Build Rules From What You Learned.

MY BEST MENTAL CONDITIONS**IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK**

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- My mind tends to operate better when:

MY ATTENTION

- I don't want

MY LOOP

- My warning sign is:
- When I notice it:

MY STATE

- When my state is poor, before making big conclusions about myself I will:

MY IDENTITY

- When I hear "That's just how I am" I will ask:

MY DISCOMFORT

- Something I want to keep leaning into:

MY LEARNING

- Something I want to remain a beginner at:

MY MIND RULE

- If I only remember one thing from this stage:

BIGGEST THING I LEARNED ABOUT MYSELF

This is Compass Piece #3 - MY MIND.

COMPARE + MOVE FORWARD

Did Anything Actually Change?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Mental clarity - Before
- Focus - Before
- Need for stimulation - Before
- Automatic phone use - Before
- Ability to notice my loop - Before
- Ability to interrupt it - Before
- Willingness to challenge an old identity - Before
- What changed?
- What didn't?
- What surprised me?
- Which behaviour made the biggest difference?

What did I discover about my mind that I previously thought was simply my personality?

DON'T MOVE ON BECAUSE YOU FINISHED THE PAGES

- Continue when you have something you can point to and say:

I learned this about myself.

You don't need perfect focus. You don't need to defeat social media. You don't need to become fearless. You don't need to remove every uncomfortable thought.

But before moving on, you should have changed at least one condition around your attention, recognised and interrupted your loop, experienced some deliberate unstimulated time, challenged one identity story, and created evidence through action.

NEXT - STAGE 4

DIRECTION - Your Ideal Ordinary Day

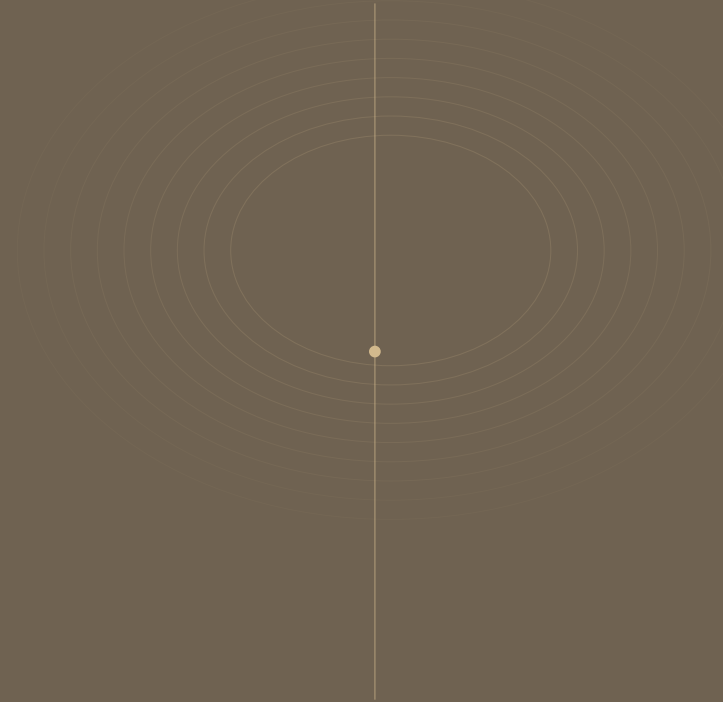
Discipline without direction can make you extremely efficient at going somewhere you never chose.

In this stage, discomfort was a way to study the Mind. Stage 5 will use discomfort more deliberately as a growth tool once Direction is clear.

STAGE 4

DIRECTION

Your Ideal Ordinary Day



Build the life that supports the person you are becoming.

Coach Kris

ALIGNMENT • THE ALIGNMENT JOURNEY

I DID THE IMPOSSIBLE. THEN WHAT?

A PERSONAL STORY FROM KRIS

I remember stepping onto my first superyacht.

For me, getting there had once felt almost impossible. I did not know the world, the route or the requirements.

I pulled the problem apart, learned one requirement at a time and eventually crossed the gate.

That moment mattered because it gave me evidence: something I had labelled impossible was learnable.

So I kept going - bigger opportunities, more experience, another challenge solved.

But the yacht itself is not the point. It was simply my version of an outside-looking-in goal that once seemed unreachable. Yours may look completely different.

Eventually I learned something just as important as learning I could get there.

Being capable of reaching something doesn't mean it is where you are meant to stay.

ACHIEVEMENT ISN'T DIRECTION

The achievement gave me evidence. The life around it gave me Direction.

But I was also away from my family.

Away from my partner.

And the more I thought about the life I actually wanted, the clearer something became.

I didn't want to spend my life endlessly chasing the next impressive thing just because I was capable of achieving it.

The question changed.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- It stopped being:

What is the biggest thing I can achieve?

- And became:

What kind of life do I actually want all this effort to create?

My answer today is surprisingly simple.

Today my Direction is about health and capability, the people I love, enough freedom to choose well, continued learning, contribution, and having enough capacity left to help when someone needs me.

That's my Direction.

The yacht helped me discover that I could do more than I thought.

Leaving that world helped me realise that more isn't automatically better.

Capability gives you options. Direction tells you which options deserve your life.

WHAT IS ALL THIS FOR?

You've spent the previous stages increasing capacity.

Better conditions for your body. Better awareness of your mind. More control over your attention. More evidence about what you're capable of.

Now we need somewhere worth pointing all of that.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Because:

You can optimise your sleep. Perfect your nutrition. Become incredibly fit. Earn more money. Build a company. Become disciplined as hell.

And still create a life you don't particularly want to live.

Being capable of solving a problem doesn't mean the problem deserves your life.

- So don't start this stage by asking:

What should I achieve next?

- Start here:

What do I want my life to contain?

DIRECTION, NOT DESTINY

You Don't Need One Great Purpose.

Purpose doesn't have to be one lifelong mission handed to you by the universe.

For coaching, purpose is much more practical: a self-chosen direction that shows up in how you spend your time, energy and attention. And it can change as your health, work, family and circumstances change.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- So don't ask:

What am I supposed to do with my entire life?

- Ask:

What am I moving toward now?

RIGHT NOW...

- What do I want more of?
- What do I want less of?
- What do I want to protect?
- What do I want to experience?
- What do I still want to learn?
- Who do I want beside me?
- Who do I want to be useful to?
- What have I been saying matters while giving almost no time to it?

DREAM BIG

Describe the Life.

Before we strip anything away, I want you to go the other direction.

Dream.

No need to make yourself smaller because something seems unrealistic.

Describe an ordinary day in a life you would genuinely love to create.

Not a holiday. Not one perfect birthday. Not winning the lottery.

An ordinary Tuesday.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- WHERE DO YOU WAKE UP?
- WHO IS BESIDE YOU?
- WHAT DOES THE MORNING LOOK LIKE?
- WHAT DOES YOUR BODY GET TO DO?
- WHAT KIND OF WORK DO YOU DO?
- WHO DO YOU SPEND TIME WITH?
- WHAT DO YOU OWN OR HAVE ACCESS TO?
- WHAT DOES YOUR EVENING LOOK LIKE?
- WHEN YOU GO TO SLEEP, WHY DOES THE DAY FEEL GOOD?

Don't edit yourself yet.

Build the picture.

THE SCENERY VS THE LIFE

Now Take the Picture Apart.

When I described my own Ideal Ordinary Day, I imagined waking beside my partner, walking to the beach, swimming, training in a beautiful gym, coaching people, holding small retreats, walking through our forest, using the sauna, reading, being with our dog and finishing the day together.

I love that picture.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- But then I asked:

What if I couldn't have the beach house?

What if the private forest disappeared?

The beautiful gym?

The sauna?

- Which parts would still have to remain for me to say:

Yes. I still want this life.

My answer came quickly.

My partner. My dog. My family. My health. A long life together. Other people. Meeting them. Hearing their stories. Helping them change.

- That told me something important:

The scenery wasn't the Direction.

The scenery was one possible container for it.

The Direction was what I wanted the container to hold.

Love. Health. Connection. Growth. Contribution. Freedom.

STRIP YOUR DREAM DOWN

Go back to the life you just described.

Now imagine some of the scenery disappears.

Take away the perfect house. Take away the car. Take away the location. Take away the title. Take away the status. Take away the luxury.

Take away anything that is desirable but not essential.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- WHAT MUST REMAIN?
- WHO MUST REMAIN?

- HOW DO I NEED TO FEEL PHYSICALLY?
- WHAT DO I NEED TO BE DOING WITH MY TIME?
- WHAT KIND OF RELATIONSHIPS NEED TO EXIST?
- WHAT DO I NEED TO BE GIVING OR CONTRIBUTING?
- WHAT WOULD MAKE THIS LIFE WORTH LIVING EVEN IF THE SCENERY CHANGED?

Now look at your answers.

Those are clues to your Direction.

Don't confuse the container with what you're trying to put inside it.

FIND YOUR VALUES FROM EVIDENCE

Don't choose values because they sound admirable.

Look at your life.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Think of three moments when you thought:

This feels like me.

MOMENT 1

- What was happening?
- Why did it matter?

MOMENT 2

MOMENT 3

Now look for the threads.

Maybe: connection, freedom, family, challenge, learning, creativity, contribution, adventure, peace, independence, service, mastery, nature, health.

MY FIVE REPEATING THEMES

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

Now choose the three that matter most right now.

DOES YOUR CALENDAR AGREE?

You can tell me family matters. You can tell me health matters. You can tell me creativity matters. You can tell me learning matters.

But now I want evidence.

VALUE 1

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Where did it appear in my last seven days?

VALUE 2

- Where did it appear?

VALUE 3

- Where did it appear?
- And now:

If somebody watched my calendar instead of listening to my words, what would they assume I value?

That question might sting.

Good.

Don't judge yourself.

Use the information.

YOUR IDEAL ORDINARY DAY V2

You have more evidence now. Rebuild the day from what you have actually learned.

Earlier in the Journey, you imagined an ordinary Tuesday with your current responsibilities, lived in a way that felt good to you - how you would wake, eat, move, work, connect, rest and sleep.

Now you know more about yourself.

So build it again.

Bullet points are enough. This is not an essay. If your schedule rotates, build this for one common day-type rather than forcing every day into the same clock.

FIRST PART OF MY DAY

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- I wake around:
- I want to feel:
- My first hour after waking contains:

BODY

- I move by:
- I nourish myself by:

WORK / CONTRIBUTION

- I spend meaningful energy on:

PEOPLE

- I connect with:

MYSELF

- I make space for:

EVENING

- My day begins to slow down by:

BEFORE SLEEP

- I would call today a good day because:

VERSION 2 SHOULD COME FROM EVIDENCE - NOT ONLY IMAGINATION.

YOUR REAL LIFE COMES WITH YOU

Alignment isn't asking you to fantasise that the children disappear, the mortgage disappears, work disappears, your health limitations disappear, or responsibilities magically handle themselves.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- WHAT GENUINELY HAS TO STAY?
- WHAT ONLY FEELS NON-NEGOTIABLE BECAUSE I'VE NEVER QUESTIONED IT?

COULD SOMETHING BE...

moved? reduced? shared? prepared? delegated? combined? removed?

- Remember:

Before adding something, ask whether we can rearrange something.

Sometimes you don't need a new life.

You need to stop living the existing one entirely on default settings.

FIND THE GAP

Compare your current ordinary day with the one you're moving toward.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Health - Current
- Morning - Current
- Work - Current
- Relationships - Current
- Learning/Growth - Current
- Rest/Enjoyment - Current

- Evening - Current
- Now:

Which gap is costing me the most?

- And:

Which gap would create the biggest positive ripple if I closed even part of it?

Don't overhaul everything.

Choose.

PEOPLE BELONG IN THE PLAN

Don't accidentally build an optimised life with nobody in it.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- PEOPLE WHO MAKE ME FEEL MORE LIKE MYSELF:
- PEOPLE I WANT TO SHOW UP FOR:
- CONNECTION I AM CURRENTLY MISSING:
- RELATIONSHIPS THAT NEED MORE TIME:
- RELATIONSHIPS/INTERACTIONS THAT MAY NEED BETTER BOUNDARIES:
- Then ask:

Does the life I'm building actually make room for the people I say I love?

WHAT DO YOU WANT MORE YEARS FOR?

Longevity can become another scoreboard.

More years. Better biomarker. Better sleep score. Another protocol.

But there is a deeper question.

What do you want the years for?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- If I received another twenty healthy years, I would want to experience:
- I would want them with:
- I would want to learn:
- I would want to give:
- I would want to help:
- I would want my body to remain capable of:

- I would want enough money to:

More life only matters if there is life you want more of.

DEFINE ENOUGH

More Is Not Automatically Better.

Money. Status. Clients. Followers. Possessions. Achievement.

If you don't define enough, more can become the Direction by default.

For me, financial freedom doesn't mean staring at the biggest possible bank balance.

It means money doesn't become the first question every time I make a life decision.

Can I help my family if they need me?

Can my partner and I take a spontaneous trip?

Can I pause work?

Are our everyday needs and reasonable wants taken care of?

Can income continue without requiring every available hour from me?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- That's what I want money to create:

Choice.

WHAT DOES "ENOUGH" MEAN TO ME?

- Financially:
- Professionally:
- Materially:
- WHAT AM I NOT WILLING TO SACRIFICE FOR MORE?
- For me, one answer is very clear:

My health.

- Because if success destroys the health I was supposedly building the success to enjoy: it is taking me away from my Direction.

TURN VALUES INTO BEHAVIOUR

If It Matters, Where Does It Live?

Choose one core value.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- I VALUE:

If I actually lived that value...

- My sleep would:
- My movement would:
- My food would:
- My phone use would:
- My work would:
- My calendar would:
- My relationships would:

Now pick ONE change.

MY DIRECTION TEST

- For the next period I will:
- When:
- What needs rearranging:
- What will probably try to pull me back:

AFTER LIVING IT

- Did my ordinary day improve?
- Did this feel more like me?

MY DIRECTION STATEMENT

Don't Make It Sound Impressive.

This is not LinkedIn.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- We don't need:

I exist to catalyse transformative human flourishing...

Write something you would actually say.

- A Direction statement answers:

What kind of life am I trying to create more of right now?

- I AM MOVING TOWARD A LIFE WHERE...
- I WANT MORE...
- I WANT LESS...
- I AM WILLING TO GIVE LESS TIME TO...
- SO I CAN GIVE MORE TIME TO...
- I WILL NOT SACRIFICE...
- THE PERSON I AM BECOMING IS SOMEONE WHO...

That final question matters.

Direction isn't only: "What do I want?"

- It is also:

Who do I want to be while I build it?

COMPASS PIECE #4

MY DIRECTION

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- MY THREE CORE VALUES RIGHT NOW - 1:
- 2:
- 3:
- THE LIFE UNDERNEATH THE SCENERY - What must remain even if the picture changes:
- I FEEL MOST LIKE MYSELF WHEN...
- THE PEOPLE WHO MATTER...
- THE CAPABILITIES I WANT MY HEALTH TO PROTECT...
- WHAT "ENOUGH" MEANS TO ME...
- WHAT I WILL NOT SACRIFICE...
- MY BIGGEST CURRENT GAP...
- MY FIRST REAL-LIFE CHANGE...
- MY DIRECTION - I am moving toward...
- THE BIGGEST THING I LEARNED ABOUT MYSELF

COMPASS PIECE #4 - MY DIRECTION

WHEN TO MOVE ON

Don't move on because you have described a beautiful future.

Move on when Direction starts affecting decisions.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- You should be able to say:

I know what matters most in this season.

I can separate the scenery of my dream from what I actually want underneath it.

I know what I want more years for.

I can see where my current calendar contradicts what I say matters.

I know one thing I'm unwilling to sacrifice.

I've changed or rearranged something in my real life.

I've tested part of my Ideal Ordinary Day instead of only writing about it.

- And:

I learned this about myself.

STAGE 5 - DISCOMFORT

Seek Discomfort to Find Comfort

Now you know where you're trying to go.

- Which means the next question becomes unavoidable:

What are you willing to become uncomfortable enough to change?

Because your Direction may require you to leave something familiar, say no, ask, begin, fail, be watched, learn, risk rejection, change your identity, or admit that something you've worked very hard to achieve isn't where you want to stay.

You have Direction.

Now we find the edge between where you are and where you're trying to go.

WHEN KNOWING IS NOT THE PROBLEM

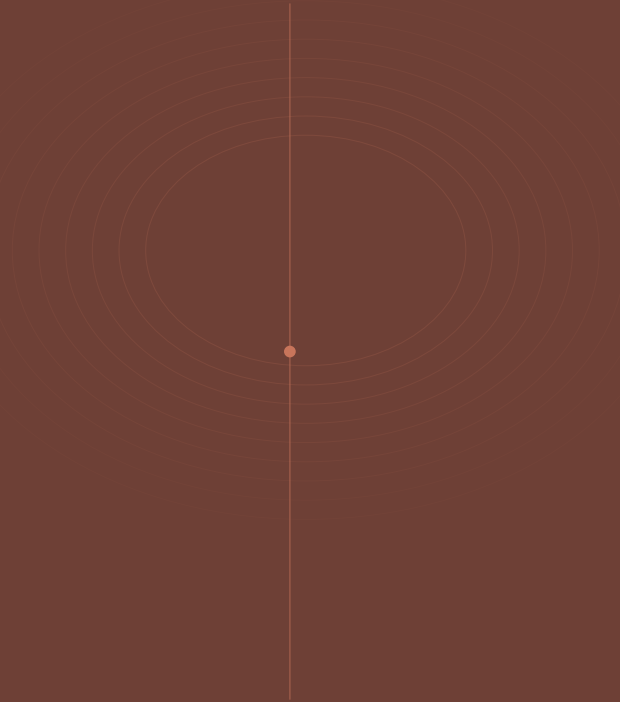
Sometimes the difficult part is not understanding what needs to change - it is doing the work while real life, fear, uncertainty and old patterns are still happening around you. That is where coaching can help turn the framework into something personal and lived.

Work with Coach Kris 1:1 - coachkris.co.uk

STAGE 5

DISCOMFORT

Seek Discomfort to Find Comfort



Build the life that supports the person you are becoming.

Coach Kris

ALIGNMENT • THE ALIGNMENT JOURNEY

THE COMFORT THAT DOESN'T SATISFY

Why "easy" and "comfortable" are not always the same thing.

The brain can make immediate comfort sound amazing.

Stay on the sofa. Watch another episode. Have the snack. Do it tomorrow.

Avoid the awkward conversation. Stay where you already know how to operate.

And in the moment, that option may genuinely feel easier.

But easy does not automatically satisfy the whole person - body, mind and Direction.

Compare sitting on the sofa because you did not want to go for the walk with coming home after the walk you nearly skipped.

Getting dressed was effort. Going outside was inconvenient. The first few minutes may not have felt comfortable.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- But afterwards you have something the sofa could not give you:
- I moved.
- I followed through.
- I experienced something.
- I did the thing I nearly avoided.
- I have evidence that I can act even when I do not initially feel like it.

I borrow a little discomfort now to buy more comfort later.

That is the kind of comfort we are building here: a life you can actually feel good inside, not only a

moment that asks nothing from you.

SEEK DISCOMFORT WITH PURPOSE

Discomfort is not automatically valuable because it is uncomfortable.

Not eating again would create discomfort. It would not make it a useful challenge. Recklessness is

not growth. Harm is not growth. Ignoring genuine physical or medical signals is not growth.

Do not chase discomfort. Chase growth - and become willing to accept the discomfort that growth asks for.

A worthwhile discomfort has a reason.

It might ask you to learn, speak, try, begin, practise, ask for help, risk an ordinary rejection, become a beginner, set a boundary, leave familiarity or keep a decision you made while clear.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Before facing an edge, ask:
- PURPOSE - What could I gain, learn, change or become?
- SAFETY - Is this reasonably safe rather than reckless, harmful or medically inappropriate?
- DIRECTION - Does this move me toward the life or person I defined in Stage 4?
- EVIDENCE - Can I do something and learn from what actually happens?

The question is not: "Will this definitely work?" The question is: "Will doing this move me forward?"

DISCOMFORT != HARM

Effort, uncertainty, awkwardness, unfamiliarity and appropriate physical challenge can be discomfort. Sharp pain, worsening joint pain, dizziness, illness, injury symptoms, severe exhaustion, medication needs or medical warning signs are evidence to stop, adjust or seek appropriate help.

If pushing, restriction or grinding are already familiar to you, your Growth Edge may be resting, eating adequately, reducing load, delegating, saying no, leaving something unfinished or asking for help. Harder is not automatically forward.

TWENTY-FIVE YEARS OF "NORMAL"

A personal story about familiarity, values and learning - not a diet prescription.

One of the strongest examples in my life was becoming vegan. The lesson is not that you should become vegan. It is what happens when your values begin pointing somewhere different from what has always felt normal.

I had spent roughly twenty-five years eating one way. I liked meat, and I had repeatedly heard it connected with strength, fitness and power. Changing meant challenging something familiar that I genuinely enjoyed.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- My mind had arguments ready:

What if I feel weak? What will I eat? Will this cost more? Can I stay strong? I also had to admit something uncomfortable: I did not know enough yet.

At first I did not do it particularly well. Vegan takeaway is still takeaway, and I gained some weight. A label did not automatically make my diet supportive.

So I learned - nutrition, protein, nutrients, meals and what supported the way I wanted to live.

Not knowing is sometimes the discomfort.

The important part is not that I got everything right immediately. I challenged something familiar, entered the unknown, got some of it wrong, learned, and became more capable.

DISCOMFORT -> EVIDENCE -> CONFIDENCE -> IDENTITY

Later, I worked in a crew where I was the only vegan.

There were questions. A lot of questions. Sometimes people challenged the decision or tried to prove me wrong.

That was uncomfortable too.

But every time I knew the answer, explained what I needed, or went away and learned something I

did not yet know, I gained another piece of evidence.

Confidence was not something I had to possess before the uncomfortable conversations. The conversations helped build it.

Over time, being vegan stopped feeling like a big temporary thing I was constantly trying to maintain.

It became part of how I live.

For me, I found a way to eat that fits my values while also supporting the strength, fitness, travel and physical capability I want from my life.

The goal is not to make yourself uncomfortable forever. The goal is to expand what feels normal.

At first: "Can I do this?"

Then: "I have done this before."

Then: "I know how to handle this."

Eventually: "This is simply what I do."

SMALL DISCOMFORT COUNTS TOO

Do not make the mistake of thinking this stage only counts if the challenge looks impressive.

Sometimes purposeful discomfort is putting the phone down when you already decided you wanted the evening back.

The urge to keep scrolling may arrive. Keeping the decision can create a few uncomfortable minutes.

If that choice is safe, appropriate and aligned with what you are trying to build, staying with the discomfort can move you forward.

The size of the discomfort does not determine the value of the decision.

What matters is whether the action is purposeful, safe and actually moves something forward.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Other small edges might be:
- Putting the phone down when you notice the loop.
- Getting dressed and going outside for the walk.
- Making the phone call you keep postponing.
- Going to the first lesson.
- Saying no when you usually say yes.
- Asking one question instead of pretending you understand.
- Walking into the room and staying for five minutes.

IMPORTANT: genuine hunger, pain, injury, illness, medication needs, exhaustion, safety concerns and new medical information are evidence. This philosophy is not permission to ignore them.

Not every uncomfortable feeling deserves to become a stop sign. But real evidence deserves attention.

WHERE IS YOUR EDGE?

You already know how to hear the negotiating voice.

Now notice where it becomes loud because something feels unfamiliar, awkward, effortful, uncertain or exposed.

What am I currently avoiding because it feels uncomfortable?

If I did it, what could move forward?

Does this connect to my Direction, growth, health, relationships, work, learning or

independence?

What would staying exactly where I am cost me?

Comfort can protect you from harm. Comfort can also protect you from growth. Your job is to learn the difference.

MAKE THE FEAR SPECIFIC

Unwrap "I can't."

The mind loves vague language.

"I can't." "It will be terrible." "There are too many things." "They will reject me." "I will embarrass myself."

Vague fear can feel enormous because it has no edges.

So keep asking until the fear becomes specific.

I am telling myself I cannot...

What exactly makes this feel impossible?

What am I predicting will happen?

If that happened, what would actually happen next?

Could I safely handle or recover from that outcome?

What other outcomes are possible that my mind is not currently showing me?

A prediction is not an outcome.

TAKE THE FEAR WITH YOU

You do not have to remove fear before you act.

Waiting to become fearless gives fear far too much authority.

You can feel awkward and still enter. You can feel nervous and still ask. You can fear rejection and still apply. You can be uncertain and still begin learning.

Fear can come with you. It does not automatically get the deciding vote.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The feeling I expect to carry with me is...
- The action I can still take while feeling it is...

"THERE ARE TOO MANY THINGS."

No. How many?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- When a challenge feels huge, the brain often compresses every unknown into one sentence:

"There are too many things involved."

Do not leave it there.

NO. HOW MANY?

Brainstorm. Problem-solve. Unwrap the goal. Write the pieces down.

The challenge I am calling overwhelming is...

What actually needs doing?

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.

Some of those steps will reveal new challenges later. Fine. Solve the problem that exists now.

A vague monster becomes a list.

FIND THE SMALLEST POSSIBLE CHALLENGE

Once the list exists, do not automatically start with the biggest item just to prove how tough you

are.

Find the smallest worthwhile challenge that actually moves the situation forward.

Of everything I listed, the smallest meaningful step is...

When will I do it?

What would count as "done" for this step?

Then do that one.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- You gain a tiny piece of evidence:

"I started."

Then you return to the list.

One step creates information for the next. One solved problem creates confidence for another.

Do not judge the final challenge using the capability you have before you

complete the steps that prepare you for it.

By the time you reach what originally looked like the biggest problem, you may have weeks or months of experience in the exact world you once knew nothing about.

UNWRAPPING THE IMPOSSIBLE

A real-life example.

My sister was a little lost in life when we had an idea based on something she was naturally good at: what if she learned to groom animals and eventually worked in or opened a pet salon?

The first reaction was basically: no, no, no - there are too many things needed.

Money. Time. Training. Work. Energy. Logistics. The whole thing looked like one giant problem.

So we unwrapped it.

One thing. Then another. Then another.

With support in the background, she found the finances, found the time beside work, put in the energy and completed her pet grooming certification.

She can now point to something that once looked enormous and say: "I did that."

And of course the story does not end there.

The next edge might be finding work as a groomer or opening a practice.

Growth moves the edge.

YOU DID NOT NECESSARILY FAIL

You may have found the next edge.

Imagine someone is uncomfortable taking a bus alone.

If the whole goal is "take the bus normally," the distance between here and there may look enormous.

So build a ladder.

- Rung 1 - Get to the bus station.
- Rung 2 - Approach the bus.
- Rung 3 - Get on, then get back off.
- Rung 4 - Ride one stop.
- Rung 5 - Ride farther.
- Rung 6 - Eventually, taking the bus is just taking the bus.

If they reached the station but did not get on, the final outcome was not completed. But something

may still have changed.

They went through levels of discomfort they had previously avoided.

Next time, those first levels may feel more familiar.

Do not measure only: "Did I finish the whole challenge?" Also ask: "How far into the discomfort did I go, and where is the edge now?"

The part I completed was...

The part that now feels more familiar is...

My next edge is...

WHEN DO I MOVE TO THE NEXT STEP?

The current rung does not need to become completely effortless before you move forward.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The signal we are using is simpler:

"It's still uncomfortable, but I can handle the next step."

That sentence contains evidence.

I have done this part.

It still creates some discomfort.

But I know more now than I knew before.

I can handle this level.

I am ready to test the next one.

The edge can move before the discomfort disappears.

My current rung is...

What evidence tells me I can handle it?

The next rung is...

SOME DISCOMFORT SCALES. SOME DOESN'T.

Some challenges can be stretched deliberately.

If your current target no longer asks much from you, a larger target can force you to organise your

effort differently, solve different problems and discover more capability.

Other challenges are personal edges that do not need to be made bigger to count.

If someone is uncomfortable taking the bus alone, the challenge may simply be taking the bus.

There is no need to turn it into ten buses.

Your edge is not determined by how impressive the challenge looks to somebody else.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Two useful categories:

THE STRETCH

A challenge where increasing the target can ask more of your current capability.

THE EDGE

A challenge that may look small externally but requires you to cross a genuine personal barrier.

Is my current challenge a Stretch or an Edge?

What would an appropriate next version look like?

DON'T ONLY WAIT FOR DISCOMFORT

Life will present plenty of uncomfortable edges by itself.

But you can also choose safe, purposeful discomfort deliberately.

This is not about collecting pain. It is a way to learn about yourself.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Trying something new can show you:
- What actually bothers me?
- What did I imagine would happen?
- What happened instead?
- What do I enjoy that I did not know I would enjoy?
- What is genuinely not for me?
- What can I handle that I did not know I could handle?

Deliberate discomfort expands the life you are capable of participating in.

Choose something that contains a real edge for YOU - not the safest challenge you can design while

technically claiming you did something uncomfortable.

A safe but real discomfort I could deliberately practise is...

What makes it a genuine edge for me?

WHEN YOUR NORMAL IMPROVES, MOVE THE CHALLENGE

This happens in the gym all the time.

A weight that once required effort eventually becomes familiar. If nothing changes, the body has less reason to adapt to that exact demand.

My own training plan sometimes increases the load in small planned steps. That is my example, not a universal prescription.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The coaching principle is broader than exercise:

When your normal improves, your challenge has to move with it.

The first lesson becomes normal. The first difficult conversation becomes something you know you

can survive. The first application becomes one of many. The first boundary becomes easier to say

again.

Growth changes what "normal" means.

Something that used to intimidate me but now feels normal is...

What did that teach me about my capability?

Where has the edge moved now?

STOP SOLVING AN EXPERIENCE YOU HAVEN'T HAD YET

The negotiating mind wants certainty before action.

"What if they say no?" "What if I fail?" "What if I am terrible?" "What if I do not like it?"

Those may be possible outcomes. They are not yet reality.

You do not need to predict the entire chain.

Take the next purposeful uncomfortable step. See what actually happens.

Then recalculate.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- That gives us the Stage 5 process:

NOTICE -> DECIDE -> UNWRAP -> ACT -> OBSERVE -> RECALCULATE -> NEXT

EDGE

Solve the problem that actually exists after the action - not every problem your mind can invent before it.

The prediction my mind is making is...

The action that will give me real information is...

After I act, what actually happened?

What does the new evidence suggest I do next?

YOUR PURPOSEFUL DISCOMFORT CHALLENGE

Choose one challenge from your real life.

It can be tiny or significant. It simply needs to be safe, meaningful and capable of moving you forward.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- THE EDGE - What am I avoiding?
- THE PURPOSE - What could move forward if I face it?

- THE PREDICTION - What am I afraid will happen?
- THE REAL RISK - Is it reasonably safe, and could I recover from the likely ordinary outcomes?
- THE UNWRAP - What are the actual steps?

THE SMALLEST MEANINGFUL STEP

WHEN I WILL DO IT

Fear can come with you. Then return here and record the evidence.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED?

WHAT DID I LEARN ABOUT MYSELF?

WHERE IS THE EDGE NOW?

IF YOU DIDN'T DO IT

Do not turn one failed attempt into a verdict.

The first attempt is evidence about the size of the step. Return to the ladder.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Was the step I called "smallest" actually small enough for where my edge is today?

A networking event might become: register -> save the route -> travel to the venue -> stand outside for two minutes -> walk in and leave -> stay five minutes -> say hello to one person.

Do not shrink the Direction. Shrink the next step until you can create real evidence.

- The smaller rung I will complete next is:
- When:

If repeated attempts at the smallest reasonable rung still feel overwhelming, getting support can be part of the next step - a friend, coach, teacher, therapist or another appropriate professional depending on the edge.

MY GROWTH EDGE

Stage 5 output.

The type of discomfort I most often avoid is...

The prediction my mind uses most often is...

A small discomfort that moves me forward is...

A larger edge I am willing to work toward is...

The way I will unwrap "too many things" is...

My signal that I am ready for the next rung is...

"It's still uncomfortable, but I can handle the next step."

The biggest thing I learned about myself in this stage is...

DON'T MOVE ON BECAUSE YOU FINISHED THE PAGES

Continue when you have evidence.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- You should be able to say:
- I can distinguish purposeful discomfort from danger, harm or pointless suffering.
- I understand that small discomfort counts when it moves me forward.
- I made one vague fear specific.
- I unwrapped one challenge instead of leaving it as "too many things."
- I completed at least one meaningful uncomfortable action - or, after a failed first attempt, I returned to the ladder and completed a smaller meaningful rung.
- I compared my prediction with what actually happened.
- I know where my current edge is.
- I can recognise when I am ready for the next rung.
- I learned something about myself that I could not have learned by thinking alone.
- I learned this about myself:

STAGE 6 - RECOVERY

The Loop Isn't a Circle

You can know your Direction. You can build better conditions. You can face the edge.

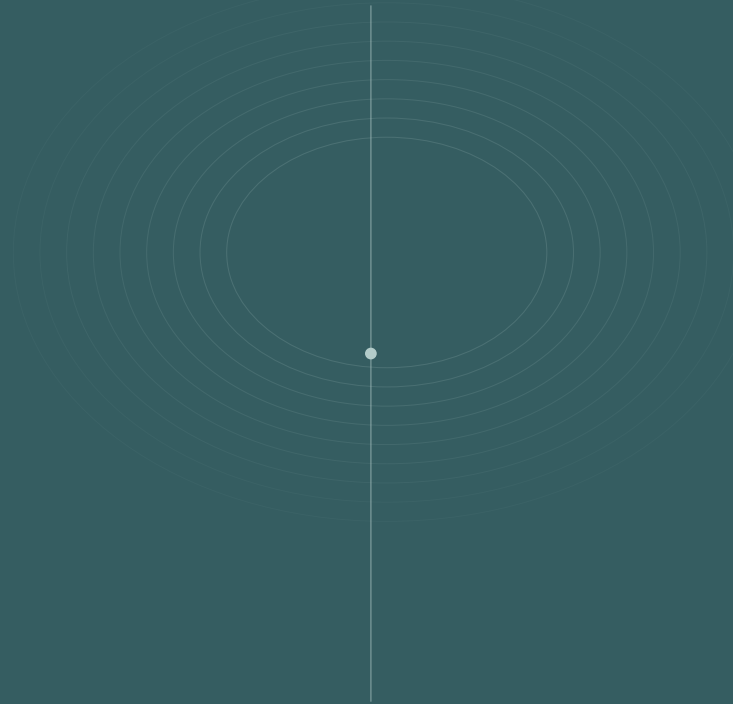
And you will still drift sometimes.

The next skill is not never falling off. It is learning how to notice sooner, recover deliberately, and return without turning one difficult day into three lost months.

STAGE 6

RECOVERY

The Loop Isn't a Circle



Build the life that supports the person you are becoming.

Coach Kris

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THE LOOP ISN'T A CIRCLE

Progress is not only the streak. It is also how quickly you notice and return.

Sooner or later, real life interrupts the plan. Bad sleep. Travel. Stress. Illness. A hard week. An argument. A

late night. A missed workout. Different food. Too much work. Too much training. Or simply a few days where

you stop doing the things that normally help you operate well.

The goal of Alignment was never to create a person who never drifts.

The stronger goal is to become someone who can notice the drift, understand what is happening, and return

before one difficult day quietly becomes one difficult month.

The loop is not a circle. A circle brings you back to exactly the same point. A spiral can bring you through

familiar territory carrying new awareness, evidence and recovery skills.

You may recognise the place. You do not have to be the same person inside it.

This stage is not about perfect streaks. It is about becoming trained at return.

A BREAK IS NOT AUTOMATICALLY DRIFT

The difference is conscious participation.

You can deliberately take a break and remain completely aligned with yourself.

You might decide to skip a walk tomorrow because you unexpectedly covered twice your usual distance today.

You might deliberately have a quieter day after travel. You might plan a Friday movie because you want to

enjoy it.

The problem begins when the choice changes without you noticing.

CONSCIOUS PAUSE

I know I am outside my normal routine. I am choosing it. I understand why. I have some idea of what

returning looks like.

UNPLANNED DRIFT

I am no longer deliberately choosing this. I am not enjoying where it is taking me. But I keep repeating

it anyway.

A conscious day off does not break Alignment. Losing conscious participation does.

The question is not simply, "Did I miss the habit?" It is: "Did I choose this, and do I still know where I am going next?"

WATCH THE CASCADE

One missed habit is not the same as a system beginning to slide.

For me, one of the clearest warning signs is not that one thing disappears. It is that the slip begins to spread.

- The morning walk goes.
- Then water starts slipping.
- Nutrition becomes less deliberate.
- Movement drops.
- Sleep or evening routines begin moving with it.

A planned break from one thing can be fine. But when the habits I know support me begin dropping one by one

without a plan, I know I am no longer simply resting.

One conscious pause can be recovery. A chain of unplanned withdrawals from the things that support you is drift.

Find your own cascade before you need it.

The first habit that tends to slip for me is...

The SECOND thing that tells me the slip is beginning to spread is...

The habits I most need to protect because they support everything else are...

THE GOAL I REACHED - THEN LOST

A personal Recovery story from Kris.

Years ago I completed a weight-loss challenge. I reached the result and felt amazing. I knew how good it felt to be fitter and healthier.

But the routines that got me there were built inside a bubble. They worked while the challenge, structure and

motivation were holding everything together. They were not yet realistic enough to become my normal life.

Little by little the habits slipped, and I gained the weight back.

What followed was harder than the first transformation. I now knew exactly how good the other side felt, but for

some reason I could not seem to reach it again.

For years I kept trying to restart at 100%. All or nothing. Recreate the old plan. Recreate the old motivation.

Recreate the old result.

I was trying to return to an old result instead of building a new reason to move forward.

Back then I did not have language for loops, spirals, return anchors or how I personally operate. I only had the

weight of knowing what I had once achieved and the disappointment of not being there anymore.

STOP TRYING TO RECREATE THE FIRST TIME

The next version may need a different reason.

Eventually something changed. I stopped eating a certain way simply because a plan told me that was how to

lose weight.

I started asking what food would support my body and my long-term health.

I stopped exercising only because I wanted to lose something. I started moving because I wanted to keep

something: strength, health, physical capability, self-respect and the ability to live the life I was building.

The old finish line had already been reached once. It no longer carried the same mystery or power. I needed a

Direction that could keep pulling after the finish line.

A finish line can motivate you to arrive. A strong Direction can help you keep moving after you get there.

Think of motivation like wind. You can have plenty of wind and still go nowhere if the sail is set badly.

You do not control the wind. But you can learn to set the sail.

Am I currently trying to recreate an old result or an old feeling?

What would give this behaviour a reason that continues AFTER the result is reached?

CHOOSE A RETURN ANCHOR

Do not rebuild your whole life at once.

My simplest return anchor is usually water.

When everything feels messy, I can almost always get water. I can take a minute, record what I have had, and

decide what I am doing next. My personal hydration target is mine - it is not a universal prescription. The useful

part is the behaviour.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- That tiny action tells me something important:

I am no longer only inside the spiral. I am observing it and making a decision inside it.

A Return Anchor is one familiar, accessible, supportive behaviour you can deliberately restore when everything

else feels too complicated.

A RETURN ANCHOR SHOULD BE

Simple enough to begin. Available in the life you actually have. Helpful to you. Clear enough that you

can tell whether you did it. Small enough that it creates evidence quickly.

Another time, making sourdough became an anchor for me. The dough needed attention throughout the day,

which gave the day some structure, created a task to return to, and eventually gave me food I was proud to

make.

The anchor does not have to look impressive. It needs to help you start participating again.

ONE ANCHOR -> SELF-TRUST -> NEXT ANCHOR

Return is a sequence, not an overhaul.

When I restore one habit deliberately for a few days, I often notice other habits begin returning by themselves.

If they do not, I bring the next one back the same way.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Every restored habit gives me evidence:

I can bring myself back.

That is a stronger identity than "I never fall off."

- A useful return can look like:

ONE ANCHOR -> repeat it -> it begins feeling normal again -> self-trust returns -> protect another

promise -> restore the next anchor

You do not need to prove that you can fix everything today. You need evidence that return has started.

My easiest Return Anchor is...

I will know it is beginning to feel normal again when...

The next habit I would probably restore is...

PROTECT THE PATTERN. REDUCE THE LOAD.

A hard day does not always require deleting the habit.

Sometimes I do not want to go to the gym. I may also know that my body needs a lighter day.

On those days I have sometimes still gone to the gym, sat in the stretching area for thirty minutes, listened to

music, stretched gently, and gone home.

I did not complete the workout. But I kept the appointment with myself.

This is still what I do. Today just looks different.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- That gives us three useful levels:

FULL

If your normal routine is genuinely doable, do the normal routine.

SCALED

Reduce the load while preserving as much of the pattern as makes sense. A shorter walk. Gentle movement. A simpler meal. A quieter version.

MINIMUM VIABLE

- When circumstances genuinely make more unrealistic, choose the smallest meaningful act that says:

"I am still taking care of myself."

Reduce the load before you automatically delete the habit.

THE MINIMUM IS THE FLOOR - NOT THE

TARGET

Do the most supportive version genuinely available to you today.

A Minimum Viable Day should never become an excuse to automatically shrink every difficult day.

Some of the strongest evidence you can collect comes from days when everything felt difficult and you still

managed more than your mind predicted.

"I travelled all day and still took care of my nutrition."

"I really did not want to train, but I went."

Those are high-value days because they become evidence for future difficult days.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- At the same time, not every day can hold the full version. So the rule is:

Do the most supportive version genuinely available. If the full version is not realistically available, scale it rather than abandon yourself.

Examples of a minimum might be five minutes outside instead of a long walk, one deliberate glass of water

instead of obsessing over a full daily target, standing and moving gently instead of a workout, or one simple

nourishing choice instead of a perfect meal.

The minimum is not "good enough forever." It keeps the thread alive until more is available.

SOMETIMES SELF-CARE IS THE

UNCOMFORTABLE CHOICE

Stage 5 does not disappear when Recovery begins. Some helpful actions still require effort.

Sometimes the walk, supportive meal, earlier bedtime, difficult conversation or gentle movement is the uncomfortable choice that helps the system recover.

And sometimes self-care is genuinely stopping.

The question is not: Which option proves I am disciplined?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Ask instead:

What does the evidence say my system actually needs?

Illness, injury, pain, acute or unusual exhaustion, significant sleep debt, grief, medical advice, safety concerns or other meaningful new evidence can change the decision. Rest or reduced load can be the responsible action.

The mind can sometimes sell avoidance as self-care. It can also sell over-pushing as discipline. State before story still applies in Recovery.

Sometimes purposeful discomfort is doing the helpful thing you would rather avoid. Sometimes it is admitting that pushing is no longer helping and choosing real recovery instead.

RESPONSIBILITY, NOT PUNISHMENT

Knowledge can help you - or become ammunition against you.

One strange part of knowing a lot about health is that the knowledge can turn against you when you drift.

You know why sleep helps. You know why movement matters. You know what supportive nutrition feels like.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- So when you stop doing those things, your mind can say:
- "You KNOW better."
- "How can you still be doing this?"
- "Look what you are doing to yourself."
- "You should not be here again."

Now the consequence hurts twice: first because the behaviour does not support you, and then because you

attack yourself with everything you have learned.

Shame can become another downward step in the spiral.

Responsibility is different.

Yes, this slipped. Yes, I pushed too far. Yes, I am choosing to rest today. And

yes, I remain responsible for my next decision.

Take the shame out without taking the responsibility out.

RECOVERY OR ESCAPE?

Define recovery before exhaustion tries to define it for you.

For me, genuine recovery might look like good sleep, sometimes a little extra sleep, slower movement,

adequate food, a quieter day, less pressure, or deliberately reducing training load.

It is not automatically a week of doomscrolling just because doomscrolling requires less effort.

Rest and avoidance can look similar from the outside. The difference is what

they are doing for you - and where they are taking you next.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Before calling something recovery, ask:

Will this likely leave me better supported - or worse?

Am I recovering, or am I escaping?

Is this response based on new evidence or simply "I do not feel like it"?

Do I know what I am returning to?

Recovery has a purpose. Good recovery makes re-entry more possible, not progressively less likely.

PLAN RECOVERY WHILE CLEAR

When possible, decide before the negotiator asks for the day off.

I prefer to decide on a recovery day the day before - or several days ahead - rather than inventing it at the

exact moment I do not feel like doing the work.

If I normally walk around 7 km and unexpectedly cover 15 km today, I can see that I used more resources than

planned. While I am clear, I can decide: "Tomorrow I will take it easier."

Now recovery has a reason, a boundary and a place in the system.

Plan recovery while clear - not only when comfort is asking for permission.

Plans can still change when genuine new evidence appears: illness, injury, unusual fatigue, pain, family needs,

medical advice or safety concerns.

But if the only new evidence is "today I do not feel like it," recognise that the negotiator may have just

entered the Recovery stage too.

Planned recovery makes recovery a specific slot rather than a doorway that quietly stays open forever.

PLAN THE RETURN BEFORE YOU TAKE THE

BREAK

Enjoyment is allowed. Drift does not need to be accidental.

Imagine I deliberately decide that Friday night I will watch one movie.

That is not a failed no-TV streak. I planned an exception and I want to enjoy it.

But I also know something about myself: Saturday evening the negotiator may arrive and say, "That was nice.

Let us do it again."

By now I do not need to wonder who that is. I can predict him.

So before Friday is finished, Saturday has a plan.

Plan the break before the break plans itself. Plan the return before you take the break.

Maybe Saturday evening is reading, meeting someone, walking, cooking, or simply putting the book where the

TV remote usually wins.

You can be resting today and still prepare for tomorrow's success.

The deliberate break I want to allow is...

The negotiation I predict afterward is...

My return plan is...

One thing I can place in my environment to make that return easier is...

RETURN - DON'T REPAY

Yesterday does not need to be punished.

The classic thought after a slip is: "I ruined it." Then the mind offers another extreme to repair the first one.

- Eat far less today to make up for yesterday.
- Train twice as hard.
- Restart perfectly on Monday.
- Punish yourself until you feel you have paid the debt.

That is not Recovery. It is one extreme trying to repair another.

Once you notice the drift: good. Now return.

RETURN - DON'T REPAY.

If going straight back to your full normal routine feels doable, do it. If the reason you slipped included genuine

fatigue or overload, a half-effort or scaled day can reconnect you with the pattern while giving you some

additional recovery.

The goal is re-entry, not punishment.

Do not punish today for what happened yesterday.

THE HORIZONTAL SPIRAL

The loop is not a circle because you can return with more evidence than you had before.

Most of us enter the spiral from somewhere around our normal operating level. Supportive behaviours disappear, pressure accumulates, or we overreach until the system starts moving in the wrong direction.

You can spiral downward from doing too little. You can also spiral after pushing too far upward - too much training, work, goal obsession or too little recovery.

The goal is not a perfectly straight line. It is recognising the direction sooner and changing it.

Progress is not only the streak. It is also how quickly you notice and return.

Each return can leave you with more situational knowledge than the previous one. The same tool will not always work, but repeated experience can make the route back shorter.

The spiral gets shorter.

THE TILT CREATES THE SPIRAL

You can leave Alignment by doing too little - or by trying too hard.

In my coaching model, BODY, MIND and DIRECTION move around an observing / experiencing CORE. This is a practical philosophy, not a scientific map of consciousness.

A tilt begins when one part starts demanding resources from everything else.

BODY TILT

Overexercise, under-recovery, pain ignored in the name of progress, or physical goals consuming the rest of life.

MIND TILT

Overanalysis, constant stimulation, endless research, planning or self-talk replacing action.

DIRECTION TILT

The future goal becomes so dominant that the person stops living in the present and removes the recovery, relationships or conditions that support the journey.

You may still be moving - but tilted. And the tilt can become the spiral.

CHECK THE THREE

Do not only ask which habit disappeared.

When I notice the spiral, I can often identify the imbalance quickly.

BODY

For me, the body often needs nourishment and movement. It may also need load reduced when I have

pushed too far.

MIND

My mind operates much better with good sleep and nourishment. I also check negative self-talk, stimulation, phone use, overthinking and planning.

DIRECTION / SPIRIT

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Direction needs a body and mind capable of participating - and usually something on the horizon: motivation, a goal, a reason, a person, an experience or something worth moving toward.

Recovery is not always "do less." Sometimes recovery is restoring what the system has been missing: sleep,

food, movement, clarity, connection or purpose.

Do not only ask, "Which habit did I lose?" Ask, "Which part of my system has moved out of balance?"

Right now BODY needs...

Right now MIND needs...

Right now DIRECTION needs...

CATCH THE UPSWING

Use today to make tomorrow easier.

Eventually something begins to turn.

You sleep a little better. You take one walk. You make one good meal. You get a small burst of motivation. You

suddenly feel a little more like yourself.

Do not require that feeling to become huge before you use it.

Make a conscious decision while the window is open.

- Buy the food for tomorrow.
- Put the shoes out.
- Prepare the clothes.
- Fill the bottle.
- Chop the ingredients.
- Put the book where you will see it.
- Set up the next supportive action.

Use today to make tomorrow easier.

An upswing becomes more stable when one positive action reduces the friction for the next one.

You do not need to leap out of the spiral. Give the upward movement somewhere to go.

THE RETURN PROTOCOL

NOTICE -> CHECK -> LISTEN -> COMPASS -> RETURN

1. NOTICE

State the facts without turning them into identity. "Three habits have slipped." "I have been staying up

later." "I am overtraining." Not: "I am useless."

2. CHECK

What is happening with sleep, nourishment, movement, stress, stimulation, recovery, environment,

BODY, MIND and DIRECTION?

3. LISTEN

Which negotiation is speaking? Is there genuinely new evidence - or the same argument in a new voice?

4. COMPASS

Which anchor matters most right now? What part of the system needs support first?

5. RETURN

Take the smallest deliberate action that moves the spiral in the right direction today. Then observe

what changes.

The purpose is not to analyse perfectly. It is to move from unconscious drift back into conscious participation.

WHAT DID THIS SPIRAL TEACH ME?

Return first. Reflect second.

When you are deep in the spiral, you may not need a two-hour life analysis before you drink water, eat, sleep

or move. Stabilise enough of the system to think clearly first.

Then study the entry point.

What happened before I started drifting?

Why did it happen?

What did I stop doing that normally supports me?

What did I start doing too much of?

What needs to change so the same entry point is easier to recognise next time?

Why am I here again?

What discomfort did I avoid facing before the spiral began?

That final question connects Recovery directly back to Stage 5.

Sometimes the visible spiral is not really about food, sleep, exercise or TV. Sometimes you avoided the

conversation, the boundary, the admission, the decision, the beginner step or the change you already knew

you needed to face.

What is this spiral trying to teach me?

BUILD YOUR RECOVERY SYSTEM

Decide now, while you are clear.

Your Recovery system should make the next drift easier to recognise and shorter to exit.

MY EARLY WARNING SIGN - I know the cascade is beginning when...

MY TILT - the part of my system most likely to take over or be neglected is...

MY RETURN ANCHOR - the easiest supportive behaviour I can restore is...

MY FULL VERSION - when I can, my normal supportive routine includes...

MY SCALED VERSION - when I need less load, I can still...

MY MINIMUM VIABLE VERSION - on genuinely difficult days, the smallest meaningful act of care is...

MY GENUINE RECOVERY - what actually restores me is...

MY ESCAPE DISGUISED AS RECOVERY - what tends to leave me worse is...

MY RETURN ROUTE - when I deliberately take a break, I will prepare...

MY UPSWING MOVE - when I feel a little better, I will use it to make tomorrow easier by...

COMPASS PIECE #6 - MY RECOVERY

I know how I drift. I know how I return.

MY CASCADE WARNING:

MY MOST COMMON TILT:

MY RETURN ANCHOR:

MY FULL / SCALED / MINIMUM OPTIONS:

MY REAL RECOVERY LOOKS LIKE:

MY RETURN ROUTE AFTER A PLANNED BREAK:

THE NEGOTIATION I SHOULD EXPECT:

THE DISCOMFORT THAT MAY BE MY WAY OUT:

THE BIGGEST THING THE LAST SPIRAL TAUGHT ME:

My goal is not to prove that I never drift. My goal is to become increasingly skilled at returning.

WHEN TO MOVE ON

Do not move on because you understand the metaphor.

Move on when you have evidence that you can recognise and use your own Recovery system.

- I can tell the difference between a conscious pause and unplanned drift.
- I know the first signs that my habits are beginning to cascade.
- I have identified at least one Return Anchor.
- I can choose FULL, SCALED or MINIMUM without automatically abandoning the pattern.
- I know what genuine recovery looks like for me.
- I have a return route for deliberate breaks.

- I can notice when BODY, MIND or DIRECTION is pulling the system out of balance.
- I have practised returning without punishment or overcorrection.
- I can name something a previous spiral taught me.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Then finish this sentence:

The next time I notice the spiral, I want to remember...

You have now learned how you operate, what supports your body, how your mind negotiates, what you are

moving toward, how to face purposeful discomfort, and how to return when the system tilts.

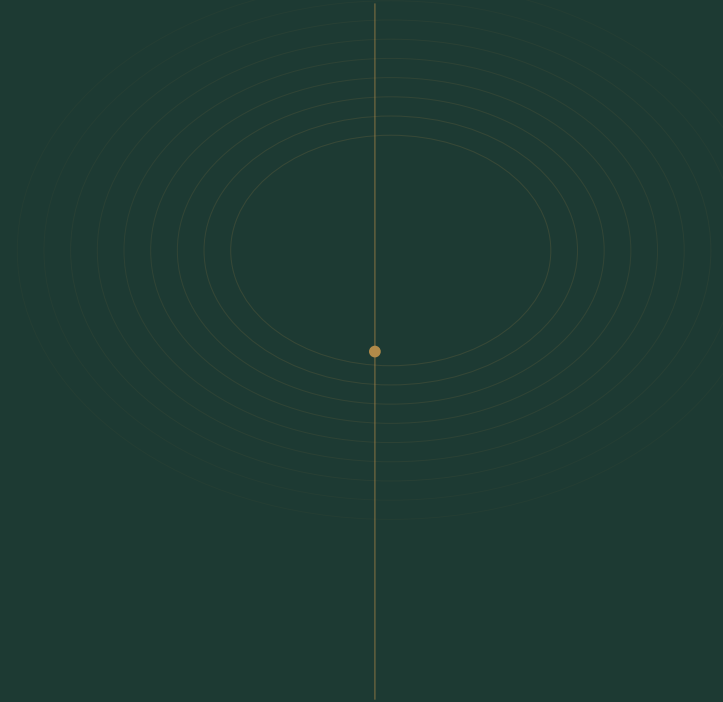
Now we put the whole thing together.

STAGE 7 - ALIGNMENT: Build Your Alignment Compass

STAGE 7

ALIGNMENT

Build Your Alignment Compass



Build the life that supports the person you are becoming.

Coach Kris

ALIGNMENT • THE ALIGNMENT JOURNEY

THIS IS NOT ANOTHER SYSTEM TO MANAGE

The final stage does not give you more rules.

You have already done the difficult part. You observed yourself before changing anything. You learned what supports your body. You watched your mind negotiate. You defined a Direction. You practised purposeful discomfort. You learned how you drift and how you return.

Stage 7 does not add another pile of habits on top of that.

The goal was never to become better at managing a system. The goal was to understand yourself well enough that eventually you can put the guide down.

This stage takes the evidence from the whole Alignment Journey and turns it into one personal Compass. Not a universal routine. Not Kris's life copied onto yours. A way of recognising how you operate.

At first you may need to look at the Compass deliberately. Later, if the work has done its job, you should need it less.

You stop following the Alignment Compass. You become it.

ALIGNMENT IS NOT PERFECT BALANCE

The parts do not need equal attention. They need to stop sabotaging one another.

It would be easy to draw BODY, MIND and DIRECTION and assume Alignment means giving each one exactly one third of your attention. That is not how I experience it.

In my ideal aligned state, they need almost no attention at all. They are functioning freely enough that I am not spending the day micromanaging them.

Alignment is a non-draining state.

Life still requires energy. Training requires energy. Work requires energy. Relationships, learning, problem-solving and growth all require energy.

But when the system is aligned, I am not also paying the extra cost of fighting myself while doing them.

Alignment does not mean life requires no energy. It means you stop wasting so much energy fighting your own system.

That is why Alignment can feel energising rather than restrictive. BODY, MIND and SPIRIT / DIRECTION are cooperating well enough that I can spend more of my energy actually living.

BEING, NOT CONSTANTLY DOING

When I am aligned, I feel like anything is possible.

When I am genuinely aligned, I do not mainly experience myself as a list of completed behaviours. I experience a sense of possibility.

There is energy. Curiosity. Presence. Confidence. I can think clearly. I can act. I can notice opportunities. I can enjoy what is happening instead of constantly trying to repair myself.

I have accomplished amazing things in life just by being - not only by doing.

That does not mean action disappears. It means action is no longer being used every minute to manufacture a version of me that I am trying to become.

The system supports me well enough that I can operate from myself rather than constantly working on myself.

When I am aligned, I have access to myself.

Alignment does not make a human being literally limitless. It can, however, let you discover more of your capability before self-sabotage becomes the first limit you meet.

THE FOUR PARTS OF THIS MODEL

A practical philosophy for noticing how you operate.

PLAIN-LANGUAGE OPTION

If Spirit is not your language, use Direction / Purpose. If CORE is not your language, use observing / experiencing self. You do not need to adopt my metaphysics to use the Compass.

BODY is the physical part of the system: nourishment, hydration, sleep, movement, recovery, sensations, capacity and the conditions that help you function.

MIND includes thought, belief, interpretation, attention, planning, negotiation and self-talk.

DIRECTION / SPIRIT is my language for the pull toward something: meaning, growth, love, contribution, exploration, a goal, an experience, a person or a horizon.

CORE is the deeper experiencing / observing self in this model - the part that can notice the other parts without being identical to every thought or state.

CORE and DIRECTION / SPIRIT are separate. Direction pulls. CORE experiences.

This is a coaching and philosophical model, not a scientific claim about the structure of consciousness.

WHEN THE SYSTEM RUNS FREELY

Attention becomes something you use when friction appears.

If BODY, MIND and DIRECTION are aligned well enough, I do not want to spend the whole day checking them.

That would simply create a new form of self-management.

Alignment is not constant self-monitoring. Alignment is needing less self-management because the parts of your life have learned to work together.

This is why the Compass is not designed to become another ritual you are afraid to stop.

Use it when something feels off. Use it when you notice friction. Use it when the system tilts. Use it when you are no longer sure what is pulling you forward.

But when the parts are cooperating and you feel present?

Go live.

The absence of constant analysis can itself become evidence that the foundations are doing their job.

SHORTEN THE SPIRAL. EXTEND THE ALIGNMENT.

Stage 6 taught return. Stage 7 teaches residence.

Stage 6 gave us one measure of progress: How quickly do I notice the spiral and return?

Stage 7 gives us another: How long can I remain in an aligned state before the system needs conscious intervention again?

Shorten the spiral. Extend the Alignment.

Maybe you notice five minutes on a walk where your body feels good, your mind is quiet and you are simply there. Amazing.

Maybe later you recognise an afternoon. A whole day. A stretch of several days where the system mostly runs freely. That is evidence too.

Do not turn this into a stopwatch. Five hours is not automatically better than four. The examples are not a new performance score.

The goal is not to force Alignment forever. It is to create a life in which you can spend more and more time there.

And when the tilt eventually comes, Stage 6 is waiting for you.

SIMPLE DOES NOT MEAN SHALLOW

The foundations are often less complicated than our explanations.

I think many answers to human problems are surprisingly simple. We often prefer complex answers because complexity can feel valuable.

But a complicated protocol is not automatically a stronger foundation.

The difficult part is not always finding a more complicated answer. It is building the simple answer deeply enough that it still exists when life shakes you.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- For me, four physical pillarstones keep appearing again and again:

HYDRATION

Enough fluid for my own needs and circumstances - not a universal target copied from somebody else.

NOURISHMENT

Food that supports energy, health, recovery and the body I want to live through.

SLEEP

Enough opportunity and quality for my body and mind to recover and operate well.

MOVEMENT

Regular movement that supports capability, independence, strength and the life I want to live.

These are not "CORE habits." CORE has no habits. The behaviours are tools that create conditions in which CORE becomes easier to experience.

BUILD FOR THE EARTHQUAKE

Foundations matter most when life stops being gentle.

Think about earthquake reinforcement in a building.

The reinforcement is not there because the architect believes no earthquake will ever be strong enough to damage the structure. It is there because a reinforced structure can usually tolerate more movement than one with nothing supporting it.

Your habits, beliefs and recovery skills are reinforcement - not a guarantee that life can never shake you.

Travel can shake you. Illness can shake you. Work pressure, loss, family needs, relationship changes, success, failure, opportunity and exhaustion can all shake the system.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The question becomes less:

"How do I make sure nothing ever disrupts me?"

- and more:

"How much disruption can my system absorb while I remain recognisably myself?"

Stage 6 helps you recover after the tilt. Stage 7 helps you strengthen the structure so smaller shakes do not require a complete rebuild.

BODY - CREATE THE CONDITIONS

Support the body well enough that you can stop thinking about it all day.

BODY is not asking to become a full-time project.

The point of hydration, nourishment, sleep and movement is not to produce a person who spends every hour tracking hydration, nourishment, sleep and movement.

Build the conditions. Learn what happens. Keep what works. Then live through the body instead of constantly managing it.

Use the evidence you collected earlier in the Journey.

My body operates noticeably better when...

The first physical signs that my foundations are slipping are...

The physical behaviours that have earned a permanent place in my life are...

The things I once thought I "should" do but my evidence does not support are...

MIND - BELIEFS LIVE HERE

We cannot think through our legs.

Beliefs belong in MIND.

They influence how we interpret discomfort, food, movement, success, failure, identity, risk and what we believe we are capable of.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- One of my biggest changes was moving from a belief like:

"I exercise because I need to lose weight."

- toward something closer to:

"I move because I want a capable body that can support the life I want to live."

The behaviour can look similar from outside. The structure underneath it is completely different.

Your Mind does not need to become permanently silent. It needs to become a part of the system rather than the ruler of it.

Not every thought deserves to become a decision.

A belief that now supports me is...

An old belief I may have outgrown is...

DIRECTION / SPIRIT - SOMETHING TO MOVE TOWARD

A capable system still needs somewhere to go.

A car can have a perfect engine, working electronics, good tyres and every component required to move.

Without a route, it can still sit stationary in the driveway.

BODY and MIND can be functioning beautifully and a person can still ask: "What am I doing all this for?"

DIRECTION / SPIRIT does not need every possible ingredient at once. You do not need novelty, contribution, challenge, connection, achievement and adventure all happening every day.

It needs something.

A person. A project. A contribution. A place. A question. A challenge. A family. A craft. A future experience. A problem worth solving. Something that creates a forward pull.

Direction gives your capability somewhere to go.

What is pulling me forward now?

If this disappeared tomorrow, what part of my Direction would still remain?

CORE - EXPERIENCE, NOT PERFORMANCE

The centre is not another goal to complete.

I am still developing my own philosophy around CORE. I do not want to pretend I have a final answer about consciousness.

What feels true to me is that CORE is deeply connected with experiencing existence itself.

Not only achieving. Not only improving. Not only producing.

CORE is the state in which I can experience my inner self with less ego, noise and interference.

DIRECTION / SPIRIT may pull me toward something. MIND may help me plan. BODY gives me the physical capacity to participate. CORE is my language for the part that experiences the life those systems make possible.

That is why Alignment can feel like possibility. I am not literally limitless. I am simply meeting fewer artificial limits created by my own internal conflict.

Alignment does not make you limitless. It lets you discover more of what you are capable of without constantly getting in your own way.

A moment when I felt most like myself was...

GROWTH DOES NOT ALWAYS MEAN MORE

Sometimes growth means going deeper.

I do believe human beings need some sense of growth to feel alive. But growth becomes dangerous if we define it only as more money, more muscle, more productivity, a bigger business or another achievement.

Growth can also mean becoming better at love. Presence. Play. Contribution. Enjoyment. Rest. Curiosity. Connection. Courage. Being with people. Experiencing what you have already built.

Growth does not always mean adding more. Sometimes it means going deeper.

You can improve your ability to be present. Improve how you love someone. Improve your capacity to enjoy an ordinary day. Improve how honestly you contribute. Improve how comfortably you can simply be.

Alignment is not endless achievement. It is continued aliveness.

Where do I want to grow deeper rather than simply bigger?

THE POT THAT HELPED YOU GROW

Outgrowing a structure does not mean the structure failed.

Imagine a plant growing in a pot. The pot is not bad. At first it gives the plant structure. In human life, the "pot" might be an environment, routine, rule, relationship, belief or the current shell of what you understand about your abilities.

The roots grow because the system is working. Eventually they may reach the edge of the container.

Sometimes you feel restricted not because your old system failed - but because it worked well enough for you to outgrow it.

The answer is not automatically to destroy everything that supported you. It may simply be time to create more room.

KEEP THE ROOTS. QUESTION THE CONTAINER.

Keep what supports you. Give growth somewhere to go.

Keep what roots you. Question what contains you.

A habit can be a root when it supports you naturally. The same habit can become part of the pot if you obey it rigidly long after it stops serving you. The same is true of beliefs, routines, people and environments.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- ROOTS I want to keep:
- PARTS OF THE CONTAINER I may have outgrown:

Now imagine one root reaching beyond the pot and touching the wider forest. The goal is not an endlessly bigger pot or a perfectly controlled life. It is becoming rooted enough that you can participate in a bigger one.

The forest still has seasons, wind and difficult weather. Expansion does not make you immune to life. It gives your roots more world to live in.

BECOME THE COMPASS

A good system should eventually make itself less necessary.

At the start of this Journey, you needed questions.

What is happening? What does my body need? What is my mind doing? Where am I going? What discomfort am I avoiding? Am I recovering or drifting?

With repetition, those questions can become internalised.

You stop following the Alignment Compass. You become the Alignment Compass.

That does not mean you never use the guide again. Pull it out when life shakes you. When the spiral returns. When you have outgrown an environment. When your old Direction no longer pulls. When the data and the story stop matching.

But when the system is running freely, you do not need to keep checking it because you are afraid to trust yourself.

Measure until you understand. Do not measure forever because you are afraid not to.

Alignment is not another system to become dependent on. It is a system designed to make itself less necessary.

Otherwise: go live.

THE COMPASS WAS BUILT IN PIECES

Every previous stage gave you evidence for this page.

1 - MEET YOURSELF

What is actually happening in my life before I perform, fix or explain it?

2 - BODY

What conditions help my body operate well enough to support the life I want?

3 - MIND

What does my mind do when it negotiates, interprets, distracts or protects familiarity?

4 - DIRECTION

What am I moving toward when I strip away scenery, status and borrowed goals?

5 - DISCOMFORT

What purposeful discomfort do I need to face to create evidence and expand capability?

6 - RECOVERY

How do I recognise the tilt, protect the pattern and return without punishment?

Stage 7 does not replace those pieces. It lets them work together.

This is no longer a collection of lessons. It is your operating evidence.

COMPASS PIECE - MY BODY

What does the physical part of my system need?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- HYDRATION - what supports me:
- NOURISHMENT - what supports me:
- SLEEP - what supports me:
- MOVEMENT - what supports me:
- RECOVERY SIGNALS I respect:
- The earliest BODY sign that something is tilting:

My body does not need to become a project. It needs enough support to let me participate.

COMPASS PIECE - MY MIND

What helps the mental part of my system cooperate rather than take over?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The negotiator most often sounds like:
- The environments or inputs that make my mind noisier:
- The beliefs that now support the person I am becoming:
- A belief I am willing to update when new evidence arrives:
- The question that brings me back to evidence:

Is there new evidence - or just a new argument?

- What helps my mind become useful again:

COMPASS PIECE - MY DIRECTION

What gives the system somewhere worth moving toward?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- My current Direction is:
- What must remain even if the scenery changes:
- Something on the horizon that currently gives me pull:
- How I know this Direction is mine rather than borrowed:
- Where I want to grow deeper - not only bigger:

Direction does not need to be permanent. It needs to be alive enough to move toward now.

COMPASS PIECE - DISCOMFORT + RECOVERY

How do I expand without losing the route back?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The discomfort I am currently avoiding that may move me forward:
- My current Growth Edge:
- The sentence I want to remember:

Seek discomfort to find comfort - with purpose, not for the sake of suffering.

- My cascade warning:
- My Return Anchor:
- My genuine recovery looks like:
- When I notice the spiral, the first deliberate action I will take is:

MY ALIGNMENT CONDITIONS

What protects the state without becoming another prison?

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The environments in which I operate best:

- The routines that reduce friction rather than create dependence:
- The people or types of connection that help me feel more like myself:
- The things I need less of because they consistently pull me away:
- One part of my current "pot" I may have outgrown:
- One way I can create more room without destroying the roots that serve me:

HOW I KNOW I AM ALIGNED

Learn the feeling, not only the checklist.

The final Compass should contain evidence of Alignment itself - not only warning signs for when it disappears.

When I am aligned, my BODY feels...

When I am aligned, my MIND feels...

When I am aligned, my DIRECTION feels...

CORE feels most available when...

The smallest aligned moment I can already recognise is...

What tends to extend that state is...

Five minutes counts. A day counts. A week counts. You are learning what it feels like when the system is no longer fighting itself.

MY ALIGNMENT COMPASS

One page to return to when you need it.

BODY

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- The physical conditions I know support me are:
- The first sign BODY is off is:

MIND

The beliefs and mental conditions that support me are:

- The negotiation I know well is:

SPIRIT / DIRECTION

- What is pulling me forward now:
- What must remain even if the scenery changes:

CORE

- I recognise CORE when:

The experience of being most like myself feels like:

DISCOMFORT

The purposeful discomfort that may move me forward is:

RECOVERY

My warning sign: My Return Anchor:

- My route back begins with:

EXPANSION

- What currently roots me:
- What may now be containing me:

I use the Compass when I need clarity. I put it down when clarity has returned.

WHEN TO PUT THE GUIDE DOWN

Completion is not perfection.

Do not finish Alignment because you reached the last numbered page.

IN YOUR ALIGNMENT NOTEBOOK

Answer the prompts below in your notebook. Use as much or as little space as you need; the guide holds the questions, your notebook holds the work.

- Finish when you can point to evidence and say:
- I know what helps my BODY operate well.
- I recognise how my MIND negotiates and which beliefs support me.
- I have a Direction that is alive enough to move toward now.
- I can face purposeful discomfort without confusing discomfort with danger.
- I know how my spiral begins and how I return.
- I can recognise at least moments of Alignment instead of only noticing when something is wrong.
- I know which environments, routines and structures root me - and I am willing to question the ones that contain me.
- I can use the Compass without becoming dependent on checking it.
- Then finish this sentence:

I now know...

- One answer may remain simple:

I know that I have to seek discomfort and face the uncomfortable to find comfort.

And when you no longer need another page to tell you what comes next, that is evidence too.

THE JOURNEY KEEPS MOVING

Alignment is not a perfect state you freeze forever.

You may spend longer and longer periods aligned. You may also outgrow the routines, beliefs, environments or Direction that once helped you reach that state.

That does not automatically mean you failed.

Sometimes you outgrow the container because the roots became stronger.

When that happens, return to evidence.

Observe. Adjust. Experience. Compare. Keep or adjust again.

Build strong enough to tolerate the shake. Stay flexible enough to expand when the old structure becomes too small.

Alignment is not building one perfect life and preserving it forever. It is building a life capable of evolving with the person living inside it.

You will still have seasons. You will still drift. You will still meet new discomfort. You will still need recovery.

The difference is that you are no longer meeting those things without a map of yourself.

BECOME THE COMPASS

At first, you needed the questions.

Then you collected evidence.

You learned what supports your body.

You learned the voice of your mind.

You chose a Direction.

You faced discomfort.

You learned how to return.

And somewhere inside that process, the system became less about following instructions and more about recognising yourself.

Do not spend the rest of your life staring at the map.

Live it.

BECOME THE COMPASS.

EVIDENCE NOTES

A short reference layer - not another stage.

Alignment intentionally keeps the main Journey practical. These sources support the precise public-health references used in the Participant Edition. They do not turn the guide into individualized medical advice.

If you have a medical condition, symptoms, a history of disordered eating, significant sleep problems, pregnancy, an injury or uncertainty about what is appropriate for you, use qualified professional guidance alongside or instead of these experiments.

DO NOT SPEND THE REST OF YOUR LIFE STARING AT THE MAP.

WHAT COMES AFTER THE GUIDE

You have the map.

Now you get to live it.

Alignment is designed to stand on its own. But some changes are easier to build when you have someone beside you who can challenge the argument, help you read the evidence and turn what you discovered here into decisions that fit your actual life.

If you want that support, you can work with me 1:1.

We can apply your Alignment Compass to health, habits, direction, work, performance or the specific loop that keeps bringing you back to the same place.

1:1 COACHING WITH COACH KRIS

Build the life around what you now know.

Explore coaching and book your next step at:

coachkris.co.uk

Do not spend the rest of your life staring at the map.

LIVE IT. BECOME THE COMPASS.